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Min Shah rolls out mega Ridge restoration, plantation mission

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'Govt misleading public to force nationwide rollout of E20-blended petrol'

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'Most heroes don't listen to female directors'

MODI, PRABOWO BACK STRONGER STRATEGIC TIES

BrahMos, Astra pacts power India-Indonesia partnership

Fourteen agreements signed across defence, minerals, space, education and technology

MPOST BUREAU

JAKARTA: Marking expansion of defence ties, India on Tuesday agreed to supply BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles and Astra air-to-air missiles to Indonesia, as Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Prabowo Subianto underlined the importance of deeper bilateral partnership for a free and peaceful Indo-Pacific.

The two sides inked 14 agreements to enhance bilateral cooperation in a range of areas, including critical minerals and steel supply chains, maritime security, medicines, education, outer space, research and innovation, telecommunication and food security, further broadening ties amid growing geopolitical upheavals.

In another significant move, India and Indonesia agreed to jointly develop the strategically-located Sabang Port, which overlooks the Strait of Malacca and is around

TAKEAWAYS

» India, Indonesia to jointly develop strategically located Sabang Port

» Sabang Port to link with Andaman and Nicobar Islands

» Leaders call for zero-tolerance approach against terrorism

» Counter-terror cooperation agreement expected to be signed soon

» Indonesia becomes first foreign buyer of Astra Mk1 missile

» Defence export deals estimated above USD 600 million

» Coast Guards to deepen maritime safety and Indian Ocean cooperation

» India to invest in Indonesia's steel, nickel and rare-earth manufacturing

PM Modi conferred with Indonesia's highest honour

JAKARTA: Prime Minister Narendra Modi was on Tuesday conferred with Indonesia's highest honour 'Bintang Adipurna of the Republic of Indonesia' medal for his role in strengthening the ties between both the countries.

Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto presented the medal to Modi. "This morning, I have also been conferred with Indonesia's highest honour with immense affection. This honour belongs to the crores of Indians... it belongs to the sentiments of the

Continued on P4

Prime Minister Narendra Modi is conferred the 'Bintang Adipurna of the Republic of Indonesia', the country's highest civilian honour, by Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto at the Istana Merdeka, Presidential Palace, in Jakarta, Indonesia

PTI

100 miles away from India's Great Nicobar Port project.

"I express my support for

the development of ports in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, as well as the development and

expansion of Sabang Port in Aceh, as a strategic link between Sabang Island

Continued on P4

NORTH INDIA GEARS UP FOR WET SPELL

Three killed, five missing in landslide in Wayanad



A bus stuck in debris after a landslide at Kalladi, near Meppadi tunnel project in Wayanad, Kerala, on Tuesday PTI

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: At least three people were killed and five remained missing after a rain-triggered landslide struck a tunnel road construction site in Kerala's Wayanad on Tuesday, even as relentless monsoon rains caused deaths, flooding, landslides and widespread disruption across western, north-eastern and northern India. Southern Gujarat reported five rain-related deaths in two days, Maharashtra witnessed fatal accidents, flooding and landslides, while Arunachal Pradesh continued to battle flash floods and slope failures. Heavy rain also brought relief from intense heat in several northern states, although it caused waterlogging, road cave-ins and transport disruptions. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) has forecast increased rainfall activity across north India over the next three days.

The Wayanad tragedy occurred at a multi-crore tunnel project in Meppadi panchayat when a rain-soaked mound of excavated earth suddenly

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Road caves in on Gurugram highway, triggers 10 kilometres traffic jam

GURUGRAM: A section of the Delhi-Jaipur carriageway on NH-48 caved in near Sunbeam in Gurugram's Narsinghpur area on Tuesday after heavy monsoon rain, forcing the closure of two lanes, triggering traffic jams stretching 8 to 10 kilometres from IFFCO Chowk to Narsinghpur, and disrupting travel across the city. The collapse, which occurred at a site where the Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority

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BJP would have set nation ablaze if Ram temple row occurred under Cong

Vikramaditya Singh

In today's paper

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STRAIT OF HORMUZ

Three tankers hit in latest attacks

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: Three tankers were struck by projectiles Tuesday in the Strait of Hormuz, the British military said, in the latest attacks targeting vessels moving through the narrow mouth of the Persian Gulf.

The new assaults threatened to choke off the flow of traffic in the strait just as countries hoped to restore normal shipping practices and ease the global economic strain of the war between the US and Iran.

One of the tankers was travelling off the coast of Oman and caught fire, according to the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations centre. Iranian state television said the liquefied natural gas tanker

THE NEW ASSAULTS THREATENED TO CHOKE OFF THE FLOW OF TRAFFIC"

came under attack after ignoring warnings but did not directly claim the assault.

Two other tankers were also hit, including one that was struck by a drone. It was not immediately clear where they were at the time of the attacks. Both of those ships sustained some damage, but no one was injured, the maritime agency said. At least one of the vessels continued on its way, the maritime agency said. Tehran, which has

repeatedly declared that only its approved route through the strait is safe, is suspected of attacking other ships that have used another route close to the Omani shore.

The US is eager to press ahead with negotiations with Iran aimed at fully reopening the strait, rolling back Tehran's disputed nuclear program and reaching a permanent end to the war launched February 28. Previous attacks in the strait have sparked retaliatory strikes by the US Iran then attacked Gulf Arab states.

In peacetime, a fifth of all traded oil and natural gas passed through the channel.

Meanwhile, talks between Iran and the US

Continued on P4

CJP's X account back online after HC order

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Tuesday ordered the restoration of the X account of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), after the Centre told the court that the reasons for withholding the handle no longer existed since the NEET re-test had concluded.

Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma passed the order while hearing a petition filed by CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, who had challenged the blocking of the party's X account on May 21 as a "disproportionate" action. Soon after the order, the original handle, CJP_for_India, became accessible again on X.

Appearing for the Centre, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the account had been withheld to prevent

Appearing for the Centre, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the account had been withheld to prevent "chaos" among students and parents before the June 21 NEET re-test

"chaos" among students and parents before the June 21 NEET re-test. "Several posts would have created chaos among the students and their parents. Of course, now the examination is over," he submitted, adding that the government had no difficulty revoking the order at this stage while urging restraint in view of students' interests.

Allowing the petition, Justice Sharma observed,

Continued on P4

PRIVATE SCHOOLS ADD 88 LAKH

Enrolment in govt schools fell by nearly 86 lakh between 2023-24 and 2025-26

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Student enrolment in government schools dropped by nearly 86 lakh between the 2023-24 and 2025-26 academic years, while private unaided recognised schools gained more than 88 lakh students during the same period, according to the UDISE+ 2025-26 report released by the Ministry of Education.

UDISE+ (Unified District Information System for Education Plus) is the Centre's official digital database for the education sector. It compiles real-time information on school infrastructure, student enrolment and teacher-related indicators across the country.

The report showed that total enrolment from the foundational to the secondary

CLOSER LOOK

» Total enrolment slipped from 24.80 crore to 24.72 crore

» Overall student enrolment declined by about 8.26 lakh

» Govt school enrolment dropped from 12.75 crore to 11.89 crore

» Private unaided school enrolment rose from 9 crore to 9.89 crore

» Number of schools declined from 14.72 lakh to 14.67 lakh

» Teacher strength increased from 98.08 lakh to 1.03 crore

» Pupil-teacher ratio improved from 25:1 to 24:1

» Zero-enrolment schools fell from 12,954 to 5,663

level stood at 24.72 crore in 2025-26, down from 24.80 crore in 2023-24, a decline of about 8.26 lakh students.

Government school enrolment fell from

12.75 crore to 11.89 crore during the period.

In contrast, enrolment in private unaided recognised schools increased from 9 crore to 9.89 crore.

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Argentina rallies to beat Egypt 3-2 and reach the World Cup quarterfinals

ATLANTA: Enzo Fernandez scored in stoppage time to give Argentina an incredible 3-2 win over Egypt and a spot in the World Cup quarterfinals on Tuesday.

The defending champions had trailed 2-0 after goals from Yasser Ibrahim and Mostafa Zico at Mercedes-Benz Stadium. But Argentina got two late goals in four minutes from Cristian Romero and Lionel Messi to get back in the game.

Messi also missed a chance in the first half when his penalty was saved by Egypt goalkeeper Mostafa Shobeir. He also hit the post when the score was 1-0.

AGENCIES

SIT report flags security lapses in Ram Temple donation theft

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

AYODHYA: The Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the Ram Temple donation theft has found serious security lapses, weak supervision and violations of standard operating procedures that allegedly enabled the embezzlement of cash offerings, according to its preliminary report placed before the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Trust's Kshetra Trust on Monday.

The report identifies Ramshankar Yadav alias Tinnu as the central figure in the alleged fraud and says he had possession of keys to several donation boxes (hundis) inside the temple complex despite having no formal or written authorisation from the trust.

According to the SIT, Tinnu facilitated the appointment of his nephew, Manish Yadav, in the cash counting process and had him posted on counting duty, thereby creating an opportunity to siphon off money from donations.

The report states that CCTV footage available for 45 days captured the accused stealing bundles of currency notes on nearly 70 occasions. However, investigators said the actual extent of the theft and the amount embezzled may never be known because only 45 days of footage was preserved. The footage available covered the period beginning April 27, 2026, and there is no record of any earlier incidents.

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Iran thanks India as report alleges US lobbied nations to skip Khamenei funeral



MPOST BUREAU

TEHRAN: Iran has publicly thanked India for sending an official delegation to the state funeral of late Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, a gesture that came as Iranian media alleged that several countries either stayed away from the ceremonies or lowered their level of representation following pressure from the United States.

In a post on X on Monday, the Embassy of the Islamic Republic of Iran in India expressed gratitude to the Indian government and people for attending the funeral and paying tribute to Khamenei.

"The Embassy of the Islamic Republic of Iran in the Republic of India extends its heartfelt gratitude and sincere appreciation to the friendly Government and people of India, especially the official delegation that attended on behalf of the Government and people of India," the embassy said. It added that "the people of Iran will never forget this gesture of friendship, compassion, and heartfelt respect."

India's delegation included Minister of State for External Affairs Pabitra Margherita and Bihar Governor Lt General Syed Ata Hasnain (Retd). They were joined by former Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister

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FAMILY SEEKS STRICT PUNISHMENT, SUPPORT FOR CHILDREN

Scooter rider killed in Mercedes hit-&-run; driver apprehended

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a hit-and-run case, a scooter rider was killed after being struck by a Mercedes car in northwest Delhi's Jahangirpuri area, police said on Tuesday.

The driver of the luxury car was arrested on Tuesday in connection with the accident that took place on July 5 near the foot overbridge at the Jahangirpuri Bus Stand on the Outer Ring Road.

The deceased was identified as 45-year-old Deepak, a resident of Mangolpuri. He was on his way to work when the accident took place early in the morning. Police rushed to the spot after receiving information about the accident and found the scooter rider critically injured.

"He was rushed to the Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial Hospital, where doctors declared him dead," a police officer said.

According to police, a crucial breakthrough came after a PCR caller informed them that a Mercedes car bearing a Hary-



ana registration number had hit the scooter and sped away from the spot.

"The vehicle was traced, and a notice under Section 133 of the Motor Vehicles Act was served on its registered owner. The owner disclosed that Ansh Pratap Singh was driving the car at the time of the accident," the officer said.

Based on the investigation, Singh was identified as the accused and arrested. A case has been registered at Jahangirpuri police station under Sections 281 (rash driving)

and 106(1) (causing death by negligence) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Police said the Mercedes involved in the accident has been seized and further investigation is underway to ascertain the exact sequence of events leading to the fatal crash.

For Deepak's family, however, the arrest has done little to lessen the pain of losing the man who was the sole earning member of the household. His wife, Geeta, recalled that July 5 had begun like any other day. "I cooked food for him

TAKEAWAYS

» 'I got to know that the driver has been arrested, but police must ensure strict action against him,' she said

» According to Geeta, Deepak's death has left the family without any financial support. 'He was the sole breadwinner of our family'

before he left for work. I was sleeping with my two-year-old daughter while my son was in another room studying," she said. She said she received several phone calls but could not answer them. "Later, my son received a call from the police. They informed us about the accident and asked us to reach the police station," she said.

Geeta said Deepak worked for a tiles company and had left home for his office that morning at 6 am.

"My husband was riding at a normal speed. He never used

to drive fast. The speeding luxury car rammed him, left him bleeding on the road and fled the scene," she said, struggling to hold back tears.

She said she later learnt that the driver had been arrested but insisted that the authorities ensure he is punished.

"I got to know that the driver has been arrested, but police must ensure strict action against him," she said.

According to Geeta, Deepak's death has left the family without any financial support. "He was the sole breadwinner of our family. He was taking care of our 18-year-old son and our two-year-old daughter," she said.

Overcome with grief, Geeta said she fainted after receiving news of her husband's death.

Deepak's wife appealed to the government for support. Neighbours described him as a devoted family man and demanded strict punishment for the accused, alleging his life could have been saved had the driver stopped and taken him to hospital.

67-year-old sentenced to 20 years RI for raping 6-year-old girl

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court has sentenced a 67-year-old man for raping a six-year-old girl in 2024, saying a strong message must be conveyed to society that such offences against children will not be tolerated.

Additional Sessions Judge Ajay Nagar was hearing arguments on sentencing the man who had been earlier convicted under the penal provision of rape and Section 5(m) (aggravated penetrative sexual assault on a child below 12 years) of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act. Special Public Prosecutor Rajesh Sirohi said that the mental trauma faced by the survivor will remain in her memory forever, and so the convict deserved no leniency.

In an order dated July 3, the court said, "There are aggravating circumstances, i.e., the survivor was at the age of about six years at the time of the offence, and the convict was 65 years of age."

"Such incidents are increasing day by day in society, and there must be some deterrence in the city, and a strong message must be conveyed to society that such offences against children shall not be tolerated

'Such incidents are increasing day by day in society, and there must be some deterrence in the city...'

under any circumstances and such offenders shall be dealt with strictly by the court," it said. The court, however, also detailed the mitigating circumstances, such as the convict being from a poor stratum of society, not having any previous conviction record, there being nothing on record to suggest that he is beyond reformation and the convict being the only bread earner of the family, including one daughter and six maternal granddaughters.

"Convict is sentenced to undergo rigorous imprisonment (RI) of 20 years and a fine of Rs 5,000 for the offence under Section 5(m) punishable under Section 6 of POCSO Act," the court said. It also provided a compensation of Rs 10.5 lakh to the survivor, saying she deserves rehabilitation, integration and financial support to live her future life without any trauma and stress. **MP05T**

Court directs inquiry into 'custodial torture' by CBI

NEW DELHI: Custodial violence is one of the gravest assaults on the rule of law, said a Delhi court on Tuesday, directing a fair and impartial inquiry into the allegations of torture by the CBI of an accused in a Rs 3-crore bribery case linked to the agency's probe into a fake drug manufacturing racket.

Underlining that allegations of custodial torture, particularly when directed against officers of the country's premier investigating agency, cannot be permitted to remain unanswered, the court directed strict criminal as well as departmental proceedings if the inquiry revealed a criminal offence or departmental misconduct.

Special Judge Sushant Changotra was hearing the plea of co-accused Prabhat Kumar (Kapoor), moved by his advocate Prateek Som, alleging severe beatings due to which he suffered serious injuries in his left ear and on his left thigh, during his CBI custody from June 16 to 22.

The court said that the medico-legal cases (MLC's) dated June 19, recording a contusion over the left thigh, and June 20, showing blood clots and a bulge/hematoma in the left ear, prima facie established that Kumar sustained physical injuries while he was in the exclusive custody of CBI officials.

It said, "These are not vague or bald allegations but are prima facie supported by contemporaneous medical records prepared by government doctors during the subsistence of police custody."

The court said that the agency has offered absolutely no explanation whatsoever regarding their cause, and it is not even the case of the CBI that the injuries were self-inflicted or accidental.

It said the unexplained injuries, coupled with the admitted movement of the accused to another police station during police custody and the contemporaneous medical evidence lend substantial prima facie support to the allegations of custodial violence.

The court ordered a high-level CBI inquiry into the custodial violence allegations, saying torture violates Article 21 and undermines public faith in the criminal justice system. **PTI**

News at a glance

UNIDENTIFIED MAN'S BODY FOUND IN DRAIN

NEW DELHI: The decomposed body of an unidentified man was recovered from a drain near Johar Wala Park in Bhajanpura on Monday, police said. No external injury marks were found on the body. A tube of puncture repair adhesive solution, commonly misused as an inhalant, was recovered from the deceased's pocket, though police said it was too early to link it to the death. The body has been sent for post-mortem, and efforts are underway to establish the man's identity, ascertain the cause of death.

GANG LEADER AMONG FOUR ARRESTED WITH PISTOLS, KNIVES

NEW DELHI: Four members of a newly formed gang, including its alleged leader, were arrested with two pistols, live cartridges and knives in Dwarka, police said on Tuesday. The accused, all residents of Bindapur, were apprehended during a raid on July 2. Police said the gang leader, Aman alias Sukka, was attempting to establish his own gang after being influenced by a Punjab gangster.

FOUR NABBED AFTER PREET VIHAR ROAD RAGE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested four people in connection with a road rage incident in Preet Vihar in which members of two families clashed following a minor collision between their cars. Videos of the brawl went viral, drawing criticism after two police personnel were seen filming the fight instead of intervening. Police officials said they are continuing the investigation.

Man held for hacking villager to death over repeated taunts

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GHAZIABAD: A 22-year-old man was arrested on Tuesday for allegedly hacking a fellow villager to death with a sickle and mutilating the body in Modinagar, a day after he allegedly attacked another youth with a screwdriver. Police claimed the accused was harbouring a grudge after being repeatedly mocked as "Baba", "Siddhidata" and "Nashedi" by the victims.

The accused, identified as Niranchal alias Mantri, was arrested after Tarun's body was found in a sugarcane field in Puthri village under Niwari police station limits. Police recovered the victim's mobile phone and the sickle allegedly used in the murder from his possession.

According to investigators, Niranchal attacked Tarun on the Niwari-Puthri road



late on Sunday before dragging the body into a nearby sugarcane field. The victim sustained multiple injuries, including deep wounds to the neck and abdomen.

Police said the accused fled with Tarun's mobile phone, returned home, washed off the bloodstains and went to sleep.

During interrogation, Niranchal allegedly told police that Tarun and his friends had frequently taunted him by calling him "Baba", "Siddhidata" and "Nashedi", while also mocking his religious beliefs. Police said the repeated insults

had left him deeply resentful. Investigators said the accused had been roaming around the village armed with a sickle and a screwdriver since Sunday morning in search of the group.

Earlier that afternoon, he allegedly attacked another youth, Prince, near a Shiva temple, inflicting multiple injuries with a screwdriver. Although Prince lodged an FIR, his family alleged the accused remained at large, enabling him to target Tarun later the same evening.

Following a complaint by Tarun's father, police registered a murder case and arrested Niranchal.

Rural DCP Surendra Nath Tiwari said the investigation indicated that the murder was driven by personal enmity arising from repeated taunts. Further investigation is underway.

Tree brought down by rain & strong winds hits two cars in East of Kailash

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A large tree fell onto a Mercedes and another moving car on a busy road in southeast Delhi's East of Kailash during heavy rain on Tuesday afternoon, officials said. No injuries were reported, they said.

The tree suddenly collapsed on Raja Dhir Singh Marg, damaging the Mercedes and another car that came under its branches, an official of the Delhi Fire Service (DFS) said.

The DFS said it received a call about the incident at 1.38 pm and immediately dispatched a fire tender to the spot. "Our team immediately



rushed to the spot. Three people were trapped inside a moving car after the tree crashed onto the road. All of them were safely rescued, and no one was injured," the official said.

A local resident said the tree fell around 1.20 pm while one car was passing through the road and a parked Mercedes was also hit by its branches.

Personnel of the Public Works Department (PWD) also reached the site and began cutting and removing the fallen tree to clear the carriageway and restore normal traffic movement.

The DFS officials said no one was injured in the incident but stressed the need for regular pruning and periodic health assessment of trees in the area.

The fallen tree temporarily disrupted traffic on Raja Dhir Singh Marg before clearance operations were launched.

Officials suspect the tree was uprooted by the strong winds and rain that lashed parts of the national capital during the afternoon.

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 45-year-old man was allegedly stabbed to death while another sustained injuries after a violent clash between two families with a long-standing rivalry in Delhi's Mangolpuri area on Sunday night.

Police said they have detained five key suspects, including a juvenile, and launched a search for other accused involved in the incident.

A PCR call reporting a murder in Mangolpuri was received at Raj Park police station at around 9.37 pm on July 6. By the time police reached the spot, the victim had already

been taken to Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital by his relatives, where doctors declared him brought dead.

The deceased, identified as Mahesh (45), a resident of Mangolpuri, had sustained a stab wound to his back. After legal formalities, the body was sent for post-mortem examination and later handed over to the family for the last rites.

Police also found that another man, Mukesh (35), also a resident of Mangolpuri, had been admitted to the same hospital with a stab wound to his left thigh. He remains under treatment.

Preliminary investigation revealed that the violence stemmed from an old enmity

between two neighbouring families living at Q-9/149 and Q-9/150 in Mangolpuri. Police said the families had been involved in repeated disputes, with four criminal cases — two against each side — registered over the past year over various issues.

An FIR has been registered at Raj Park police station under the relevant provisions of law, and investigators are reconstructing the sequence of events leading to the fatal attack.

Police have detained five suspects, including a juvenile, and are questioning them. Efforts are underway to trace the remaining accused, officials said.

Capital to get 38 new parking sites in bid to decongest commercial & residential areas

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has identified 38 new parking sites with a combined capacity of more than 6,100 vehicles, taking the total number of authorised parking locations under the civic body's jurisdiction to 445, officials said on Tuesday.

They said the addition of new sites is aimed at improving organised parking facilities and reducing roadside congestion in busy commercial and residential areas across the capital.

According to officials, the civic body manages 408 park-

Addition of new sites is aimed at improving organised parking facilities...

ing sites with a total capacity of more than 84,000 vehicles across its 12 zones.

This includes space for around 52,000 four-wheelers, 30,000 two-wheelers and 1,386 buses and trucks.

"The newly-identified 38 parking sites together can accommodate 4,723 four-wheelers, 1,311 two-wheelers and 148 buses and trucks," a senior official said, adding that tenders for the project will be floated this week.

Among the new locations, the largest parking facility has been identified at Dwarka Sector-14, on a stretch near the Vegas Mall, with capacity for 806 vehicles. Another major site at the British Salon-Kakrola Mod to Dwarka Mod service lane in the same zone will accommodate more than 700 vehicles.

The Patparganj Industrial Area in Shahdara South Zone accounts for a sizable capacity among the newly-identified

sites, with multiple plots and road stretches together adding over 1,800 parking spaces. New parking locations have also been identified in Karol Bagh, Rohini, City SP, South, West, Central, Civil Lines and Keshav Puram zones.

According to officials, the Central Zone has the highest parking capacity among all MCD zones, with more than 23,000 parking spaces across 54 parking sites, including 27 cluster parking facilities. It is followed by the Keshav Puram Zone with capacity for 9,135 vehicles across 56 sites and the Shahdara North Zone with 8,785 spaces at 74 sites.

EIGHT THEMED FORESTS, NEW WATER BODIES PLANNED

Min Shah rolls out mega Ridge restoration, plantation mission

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Unveiling one of Delhi's largest ecological restoration programmes, Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday launched the Mission 70 Lakh Tree Plantation Campaign under the 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' initiative, announcing a scientific revival of the capital's Ridge forests, expansion of green cover and a series of measures aimed at creating a cleaner and climate-resilient Delhi.

Launching the campaign after planting saplings at the Central Ridge and Nanakpura Ridge, Shah said, "For years, invasive and environmentally unsuitable species such as Vilayati Babool occupied the Delhi Ridge. They will now be removed and replaced with indigenous species." He added that nearly 5,000 hectares of the Ridge had now been notified as reserved forest after the final notification remained pending for almost 30 years since 1994.



"Over the next three years, the Ridge will become the lungs of Delhi with native species such as peepal, banyan, neem, arjun and jamun," he said.

The Eco-Restoration Plan (2026-30), based on Delhi's first approved Forest Working Plan (2026-36), covers 6,303 hectares of Ridge land and targets plantation of more than one crore native plants,

HIGHLIGHTS

» Launching the campaign at the Central Ridge and Nanakpura Ridge, Shah said, 'For years, invasive and environmentally unsuitable species such as Vilayati Babool occupied the Delhi Ridge. They will now be removed and replaced with indigenous species'

» He added that nearly 5,000 hectares of the Ridge had now been notified as reserved forest after the final notification remained pending for almost 30 years since 1994

» 'Over the next three years, the Ridge will become the lungs of Delhi with native species such as peepal, banyan, neem, arjun and jamun'

12 lakh saplings will be distributed free of cost.

Linking the initiative with Delhi's broader environmental agenda, Shah said, "Delhi's EV policy, Yamuna rejuvenation and Ridge restoration together will realise the vision of a Green Delhi." He also announced an agreement with the National Dairy Development Board to convert dairy waste into bio-gas and organic manure so that "not even one kilogram of cow dung reaches the Yamuna."

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the government had allocated a Rs.22,236-crore Green Budget and added, "Development and environmental protection go hand in hand. The Delhi government is ensuring clean air and greener spaces for future generations." Shah also inaugurated 300 electric buses, three electric bus depots, an automated vehicle testing station and laid the foundation stone for the Narela High-Security Prison during the event.

Delhi adds 300 electric buses

Shah unveils e-buses, prison and testing station

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Giving a major push to Delhi's electric mobility and security infrastructure, Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday flagged off 300 new electric buses for the Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) and virtually laid the foundation stone for a high-security prison at Narela. Three modern electric bus depots and a fully automated vehicle testing station were also inaugurated during the programme.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the initiatives reflected the government's commitment to building cleaner public transport and stronger public infrastructure. "The Delhi government is continuously working to build a modern, environment-friendly public transport system," she said.

The newly inducted fleet comprises 195 nine-metre DEVI electric buses and 105 twelve-metre air-conditioned electric buses. Equipped with CCTV cameras, panic buttons, GPS tracking and passenger information systems, the buses are designed to improve commuter safety and accessibility, including for



inaugurated. Together, they will provide parking, charging and maintenance facilities for hundreds of electric buses, strengthening Delhi's electric mobility infrastructure.

A four-lane Automated Testing Station at the Nand Nagri DTC depot was also inaugurated. The facility can conduct annual fitness tests for 52,000 heavy and light vehicles and 20,000 two-wheelers through fully automated systems, improving transparency in vehicle inspections.

The programme also marked the virtual foundation stone laying of the Narela High-Security Prison.

Supported by Rs.100 crore from the Union Home Ministry, the prison will accommodate over 250 inmates and feature AI-enabled CCTV surveillance, biometric access control, automated locking systems, body scanners, mobile signal jammers, anti-tunnelling technology and a central command centre.

Senior leaders, including Union Minister Bhupendra Yadav, Minister of State Harsh Malhotra, Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and members of the Delhi Cabinet, attended the event.

Initiatives reflected the govt's commitment to building cleaner public transport and stronger public infrastructure

With the latest addition, Delhi's public bus fleet has expanded to nearly 6,600 buses, including 4,845 electric buses and 1,755 CNG buses. The government has set a target of increasing the fleet to around 14,000 buses by 2028-29.

To support the growing electric fleet, new bus depots at Narela Sector A-1 and A-4, Rithala and Kohat Enclave were

persons with disabilities.

L-G says Delhi draws inspiration from 'ancient spiritual traditions'

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday presided over the India Foundation Programme at the Stein Auditorium, India Habitat Centre, in the presence of Shankaracharya Shankara Vijayendra Saraswati Swamigal of the Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Peetham and India Foundation president Ram Madhav.

Welcoming Swami Ji, the 70th Peethadhipati of the Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Peetham, the Lieutenant Governor commended the India Foundation for bringing together policy-makers, diplomats and scholars. He described it as a privilege to preside over a gathering that connected the national capital with one of India's oldest liv-

ing spiritual traditions. In his address, Sandhu described the Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Peetham as a living civilisational institution established by Jagadguru Adi Shankaracharya at Kanchipuram. Highlighting its unbroken lineage of 71 Acharyas, he said the Peetham has continued its work through three key pillars: Veda, dedicated to preserving Vedic scholarship; Vidya, through integrated pathshalas and institutions such as the Sri Chandrashekarendra Saraswati Vishwa Mahavidyalaya; and Vaidya, through a wide network of charitable healthcare institutions serving communities across the country.

The Lieutenant Governor also praised the Peetham's contribution to strengthening national integration through its

spiritual outreach in the North East and Jammu and Kashmir. He further lauded its efforts to preserve India's heritage through manuscript digitisation and the revival of traditional temple architecture.

Concluding his address, Sandhu said Delhi, as the nation's capital and a meeting point of diverse traditions and communities from across the country, continues to draw inspiration from such civilisational institutions in its journey towards a Viksit Bharat.

He said the timeless values nurtured by Sri Kanchi Kamakoti Peetham would continue to guide this collective journey with wisdom and harmony before offering his respectful pranams to Swami Ji and inviting His Holiness to deliver the benedictory address.

City must balance growth, sustainability, citizen-centric governance: L-G Sandhu

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday outlined his vision for the national capital's evolution as a global city, stressing sustainable development, environmental conservation and citizen-centric governance while addressing members of the Foreign Correspondents' Club of South Asia.

Speaking to journalists, diplomats and other attendees, the Lieutenant Governor said Delhi's story has always been one of continuity rather than merely transformation.

He described the city as having remained at the heart of the subcontinent's political, economic and cultural life for centuries and said it has



L-G Taranjit Singh Sandhu highlighted priorities including protecting natural resources, promoting water harvesting, reducing pollution...

now emerged as a key hub in global diplomatic and technological networks, hosting several major international engagements.

Emphasising that a city's global standing is determined not only by its visibility but also by the quality of governance and the ease of living it offers its residents, Sandhu

highlighted priorities including protecting natural resources, promoting water harvesting, reducing pollution and ensuring governance remains focused on citizens' needs.

He urged citizens and the media to play an active role in Delhi's development, saying the city's progress requires collective responsibility and partici-

MCD steps up waste mgmt in South Delhi

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on Tuesday directed officials to intensify sanitation measures across key areas of South Delhi during an inspection of waste management facilities, drains and ongoing civic projects.

The inspection covered dhalao at Katwaria Sarai and Deer Park, Ber Sarai and the under-construction Convenience Centre at Ekta Camp. Reviewing sanitation, Khirwar ordered intensive deep-cleaning drives, timely lifting of garbage and adequate deployment of manpower and resources. He also directed the establish-

ment of two Fixed Compactor Transfer Stations each at the Katwaria Sarai and Deer Park dhalao to strengthen waste collection and disposal.

With the monsoon underway, the Commissioner instructed engineering and sanitation teams to complete desilting and drain-cleaning works to prevent waterlogging. He also reviewed the Convenience Centre at Ekta Camp, which will provide public toilets, bathing units and laundry facilities, and directed officials to ensure its timely completion while maintaining quality standards. He stressed coordinated action by all departments to deliver visible improvements in civic services.

1,049 trees to be transplanted, 42 felled for Sarojini Nagar housing project: Forest dept

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Forest Department has granted permission to NBCC Limited to transplant 1,049 trees and fell 42 trees for the redevelopment of the General Pool Residential Accommodation (GPRA) colony in Sarojini Nagar, according to an official order issued on June 19.

The approval was granted under Section 9 of the Delhi Preservation of Trees Act, 1994, following scrutiny of the proposal and site inspections by the designated tree officer.

As per the order, the original proposal involved 1,218 trees. However, 48 trees were found to be outside the proj-

'No tree with active nests of birds, squirrels or snakes should be cut.'

ect area during verification. Later, the Central Empowered Committee directed that 79 additional trees be retained, reducing the final number of affected trees to 1,091. Of these, 1,049 will be transplanted while permission has been given to remove 42 trees.

The order requires NBCC to transplant the trees to Bharat Vandana Park in Dwarka and undertake compensatory plantation of 10,910 indigenous saplings at the same

location. The agency has also been directed to comply with the Tree Transplantation Policy, 2020, upload geo-tagged photographs of the transplantation process on the forest department's portal, and submit annual progress reports.

Authorities have instructed that no tree with active nests of birds, squirrels or snakes should be cut or transplanted until the nests are vacated. The order also mandates adequate spacing of transplanted trees, soil moisture conservation measures and protection of trees retained within the project area. If transplanted trees fail to survive, NBCC will have to plant indigenous trees with a minimum stem diameter of six

inches at a ratio of five replacement trees for every felled transplant, at its own expense. The approval remains valid for two years, extendable by one year subject to valid reasons and compliance with directions of courts, the National Green Tribunal and the Commission for Air Quality Management.

Environmental activists criticised the decision, arguing that mature trees provide irreplaceable ecological benefits and questioning the transparency of monitoring transplanted trees. They also expressed concerns that compensatory plantations often fail to adequately offset the environmental impact of large-scale tree loss in the capital.

HC seeks surprise audits of 38 Delhi govt hospitals

After denial of ICU admission despite vacant bed shown online

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court has ordered surprise audits of all 38 Delhi government hospitals where the Next-Gen e-Hospital Management Information System (HMIS) has been implemented, after a patient was allegedly denied an ICU bed despite the online portal showing availability.

A division bench of Justices Prathiba M. Singh and Manmeet Pritam Singh Arora passed the directions while hearing matters related to healthcare infrastructure and public health services in the national capital.



The order followed the case of a 70-year-old woman suffering from breathing difficulties who was allegedly refused admission at Lok Nayak Jai Prakash (LNJP) Hospital. According to submissions made before the court, the hospital's online portal showed two ICU beds as available when the patient's family arrived. They also claimed repeated calls to hospital helpline numbers failed to provide any useful information, with one call reportedly being answered by a security guard.

Describing the incident as "unfortunate", the bench observed that it raised serious

concerns about the functioning of the ICU bed management system and the accuracy of real-time information displayed on the portal.

The court directed the National Informatics Centre (NIC) to conduct surprise inspections of all 38 hospitals by July 31. The audit will examine whether ICU bed availability is being updated accurately, whether emergency helpline calls are being attended to properly, and whether HMIS has been implemented uniformly across hospitals.

The bench also asked the Delhi government to consider setting up a toll-free helpline with 10 to 20 dedicated lines for ICU bed enquiries and emergency assistance. It further sought details on whether a nodal officer is responsible for ensuring patients referred between hospitals are admitted.

The matter is scheduled for further hearing on August 7.

612 TREES, 50,200 SHRUBS PLANTED

NDMC launches mega plantation drive across 34 locations in Delhi

VIBHINTA KAUR

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Tuesday launched its Mega Plantation Drive 2026 across 34 locations, planting over 612 trees and 50,200 shrubs as part of the nationwide 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' campaign to strengthen the Capital's green cover.

The drive witnessed participation from Delhi Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh, New Delhi MP Bansuri Swaraj, NDMC Chairman Keshav Chandra, Vice-Chairman Kuljeet Singh Chahal, NDMC members, Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs), Market Traders Associations (MTAs), educational institutions and civil society organisations.

Saplings were planted at prominent locations, including Children's Park near India Gate, Nehru Park, Lodhi Gar-



den, Talkatora Garden and Central Park in Connaught Place. NDMC said it had prepared over 50,000 plantation pits in advance and surpassed its plantation target during the campaign.

The civic body planted native species such as peepal, neem, jamun, imli, champaa, ashoka, gulmohar and amalatas, along with ornamental shrubs aimed at improving biodiversity and air quality.

Representatives of participating organisations stressed

the need to ensure the survival of newly planted saplings. Neetu, associated with the Inner Wheel Mayur Vihar Foundation, said plantation drives should be complemented with regular maintenance and dedicated workers to protect young plants.

Dheeraj of Trinity Foundation said the organisation was supporting the government's target of planting around 73 lakh saplings across Delhi under the campaign and added that arrangements were being made to monitor sapling survival.

BJP MLA Jitender Dedha said the campaign sought to encourage citizens to plant trees in honour of their mothers while promoting environmental conservation. He claimed that nearly 70 lakh trees had already been planted across Delhi under the initiative, citing government figures.

Capital reconstitutes DCPCR after 3 years

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has reconstituted the Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights (DCPCR), filling positions that had remained vacant for nearly three years. The appointments were made on the directions of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, according to an official statement issued on Monday.

The Department of Women and Child Development notified the appointment of Om Prakash Vyas as the Chairperson of the commission. Rahul Gautam, Kundan Kanaskar, Swati Gupta and Monika Sharma have been appointed as members. The reconstitution has been carried out under the provisions of the Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005, the Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights Rules, 2008, and the relevant notification issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs.

The appointments will come into effect from the date the respective appointees assume office. Each member, including the chairperson, will serve a three-year term, subject to the prescribed age limits. The maximum age is 65 years for

CM: 'Safeguarding children's rights and welfare remains a top priority for the Delhi government'

the chairperson and 60 years for members. If an appointee reaches the age limit before completing the tenure, the term will end on that date.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said safeguarding children's rights and welfare remains a top priority for the Delhi government. She said every child deserves a safe and dignified childhood with equal opportunities, adding that strengthening the DCPCR is an important step towards ensuring effective protection of children's rights.

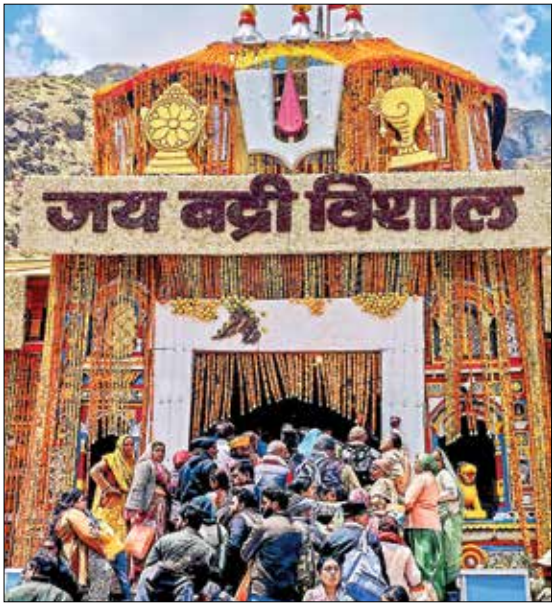
The chief minister expressed confidence that the newly appointed leadership would function with sensitivity, transparency and accountability while working for the welfare of children. She also reaffirmed the government's commitment to protecting children's interests and supporting their overall development through a stronger institutional framework.



Rohini District Police launched the pilot phase of the 'SAJAG' initiative to promote child safety and awareness. Covering one school under each police station, the programme will focus on cyber safety, drug abuse prevention, POCsO awareness, self-defence and counselling through joint efforts with the Education Dept

DHAMI GOVT FORMS PROBE PANEL TOO

U'khand: Badrinath-Kedarnath Temple body staffer suspended



Devotees gather to offer prayers at Badrinath Dham as part of the Char Dham Yatra, in Chamoli

PTI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

DEHRADUN: An employee of Shri Badrinath-Kedarnath Temple Committee (BKTC) was suspended after a four-member team on Tuesday began its investigation into alleged irregularities in the management of donations at Badrinath Dham.

BKTC is a statutory body which manages Badrinath temple and other shrines in Uttarakhand. Speaking to news agency, BKTC Chairman Hemant Dwivedi stated that the employee, Pramod Nautiyal, was suspended after a preliminary inquiry indicated prima facie irregularities.

Nautiyal was serving as a private secretary within the temple committee. Meanwhile, the Uttarakhand government has also constituted its own probe committee.

Garhwal Division Commissioner will serve as the chairperson of the three-member committee.

According to the order issued by Tourism Secretary Dhiraj Singh Garbhal, the committee will submit its investigation report and recommendations to the government within 15 days. Dwivedi emphasised that the BKTC maintains a zero-tolerance policy on corruption, and if any employee is found guilty during the investigation,

strict departmental and legal action will be taken against them. The issue gained attention after allegations of irregularities during the counting of offerings at Badrinath Dham surfaced on social media. Subsequently, an organisation named 'Bhairav Sena' lodged a complaint demanding an inquiry and the registration of an FIR.

Following this, BKTC formed a four-member panel last week. The team included Finance Controller Hem Kandpal, Legal Officer SS Bartwal, Chief Administrative Officer Rajan Naithani, and Kedarnath's Senior Administrative Officer DS Bhujwan.

Highlights

» BKTC is a statutory body which manages Badrinath temple and other shrines in Uttarakhand

» BKTC Chairman Hemant Dwivedi stated that the employee, Pramod Nautiyal, was suspended after a preliminary inquiry indicated prima facie irregularities

» According to the order issued by Tourism Secretary Dhiraj Singh Garbhal, the committee will submit its investigation report and recommendations to the government within 15 days

» Committee initiated the investigation based on CCTV footage, statements from the concerned employees, and other relevant documents

BrahMos, Astra pacts power India-Indonesia partnership

Continued from Page 1

And the Andaman and Nicobar Islands in India," President Prabowo said.

After his talks with the Indonesian president, PM Modi said: "A golden era is now at the threshold for our two nations."

Modi landed in Jakarta on Monday to a red-carpet welcome in the first leg of his three-nation tour – that will also cover Australia and New Zealand – to shore up cooperation in sectors such as trade, energy, security and rare-earth minerals under the framework of the India-Indonesia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership of 2018.

In Tuesday's meeting, Modi and Prabowo called for a "zero-tolerance" approach to counter terrorism, demanded action against globally proscribed terrorists and welcomed the early conclusion of an agreement on counter-terror cooperation between the two countries, to be signed in the "near future".

In his media statement, Modi said India reiterated its call for navigating "global turbulence" through dialogue and diplomacy, and asserted New Delhi's support for a two-state solution to the Palestine issue.

The pacts sealed after the talks included one on supply of an unspecified number of BrahMos missiles and another on Astra beyond-visual range missiles. The pacts signal New Delhi's growing role as a trusted defence partner in Southeast Asia.

The agreements also reinforce India's strategic outreach under its Act East Policy while highlighting the country's emergence as a competitive exporter of advanced defence systems.

While the BrahMos contract marks another major export success for India's flagship missile programme, the Astra agreement is particularly noteworthy as it makes Indonesia the first foreign customer for the Astra Mk1 air-to-air missile, opening a new avenue for India's domestically developed aerial weapon systems in the global defence market.

It is perhaps the first time that two Indian defence exports deals, estimated to be worth over USD 600 million, were announced in presence of the prime minister. Both weapon systems played a major role for the Indian military during Operation Sindoor last year.

The BrahMos missile deal with Indonesia came after India inked similar pacts with Vietnam and the Philippines. BrahMos Aerospace Pvt Ltd, an India-Russian joint venture, produces the supersonic cruise missiles.

The missile pacts, as well as another decision on implementation of an agreement on maritime safety and security, came against the backdrop of rising concerns in South East Asia over China's increasing military muscle-flexing in the resource-rich South China Sea and beyond.

Modi said the growing trust between the two countries is strengthening cooperation in defence, security and the maritime domain. "Today, we agreed to further enhance collaboration in defence exchanges, disaster management, and industrial cooperation," he said.

"Our two Coast Guards will now work together to enhance maritime safety and security in the Indian Ocean. As two close maritime nations, we have also decided to deepen our cooperation in the

blue economy, port development, and maritime trade," he said.

Without making any direct reference to Chinese belligerence in the South China Sea, the two leaders underscored the importance of respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity, adherence to international law, including the 1982 UN Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS), freedom of navigation and overflight while refraining from the threat or use of force.

President Prabowo appreciated India's consistent support for ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) unity and ASEAN centrality in the evolving regional architecture for regional peace, stability and prosperity, according to a joint statement.

Both leaders identified collaboration in the defence industry as one of the priority areas of cooperation. They agreed to expand mutually beneficial collaboration for joint production of equipment, sourcing of defence equipment, including cooperation in ship-building, and establishment of MRO (Maintenance, Repair, and Overhaul) facilities.

New Delhi also decided to invest in the manufacturing of steel, nickel and rare earth permanent magnets in Indonesia – key inputs for the production of electric vehicle motors, wind turbines and smartphones.

"In today's world, supply chain resilience in technology has become critically important. We have also concluded an important agreement to strengthen supply chain resilience in the areas of critical minerals and steel," Modi said.

The prime minister said India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI) will soon be integrated with Indonesia's payment system and it will

further enhance both the ease of doing business and the ease of travel between the two countries.

"Our Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, established in 2018, is reaching new heights today. We are making significant strides across every domain of cooperation, including development, security, technology, culture, and education," Modi said.

"I am confident that today marks the beginning of a golden new chapter in the India-Indonesia partnership. This new chapter will have a profound and positive impact on the world of the 21st century and on humanity as a whole," he said.

India and Indonesia also decided to boost cooperation in the space sector. "We have taken important decisions today to advance joint research, technology sharing, and capacity building in the space sector," Modi said.

The prime minister and the Indonesian president also discussed various global challenges, including the situation in West Asia. The two leaders expressed deep concerns over the situation in West Asia and its global effects, according to the joint statement. They welcomed the Memorandum of Understanding signed by the US and Iran on June 17.

"They underlined the importance of de-escalation and reiterated that all issues must be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy," the statement said.

"They also share the same view to respect freedom of navigation and global flow of commerce and the implementation of transit passage through the Strait of Hormuz, in accordance with international law including the provisions of UNCLOS," it added.

From Page 1

PM Modi

people of Indonesia, to the historic and intimate ties between India and Indonesia," Prime Minister's Office posted on X.

"I express my heartfelt gratitude to President Prabowo Ji, the Government of Indonesia, and the people here: PM @narendramodi," the post said.

Instituted in 1959, the Bintang Adipurna of the Republic of Indonesia is the highest honour in the Republic of Indonesia.

This award is given to individuals who have rendered exceptional service to the unity, continuity and prosperity of the Republic of Indonesia.

Wayanad

collapsed near Meenakshi Bridge. Video from the site showed the mound giving way, uprooting trees and sweeping away metal and cloth barricades around the construction area.

District authorities said 18 people were affected. Three bodies were recovered from the debris, while five people were still missing and 10 others were injured.

Officials identified the deceased as Chandrabhan, an equipment operator from Madhya Pradesh, Bikash Kumar, a civil foreman from Bihar, and Anmol, a worker from Jharkhand.

State Health Minister K Muralidharan said the bodies were recovered from beneath the debris and post-mortem examinations were completed at Vythiri Taluk Hospital. A police surgeon from Bathery Taluk Hospital was brought in to speed up the examinations.

Nine injured people were admitted to Meppadi WIMS Hospital. Two have been discharged, while seven remain under treatment. Two of the injured are in intensive care, including one with fractures to the head and both legs and another with fractures in both legs. Among the injured is a site engineer from Ernakulam, the only Malayali hospitalised, whose injuries are not considered serious.

Authorities said the health department, the 108 ambulance service and medical teams were deployed for rescue and treatment. A control room was opened at Meppadi Community Health Centre, while an ambulance and medical team will remain stationed at the site overnight after rescue work is suspended.

A total of 142 people from 42 families living near the landslide site have been shifted to a relief camp at Meppadi Polytechnic, where doctors and health workers have also been deployed.

Senior government officials said there were no labourers working at the site when the landslide occurred and that those trapped were mainly engineers and security personnel.

Two Kerala ministers described the incident as a "man-made" landslide. Chief Minister V D Sathesnan said police, fire and rescue teams had reached the area and a defence team stationed in Thrissur was on standby if additional assistance became necessary. The Chief Minister is expected to visit the site on Wednesday. In Maharashtra, rains eased in Mumbai after two days of heavy downpour, but flood-related incidents continued elsewhere. The death toll from flooding in neighbouring Palghar district over the past week rose to 10.

In Mumbai, two minor boys drowned and two women were injured after cement sheets collapsed inside a garden in the Andheri area during heavy rain and strong winds. Civic authorities also reported 428 incidents of trees or branches falling and 28 complaints of wall and house collapses over the past 24 hours.

Heavy rain also triggered a landslide in Ratnagiri district's Dahivali area in Khed tehsil, burying five houses. A 75-year-old woman was rescued, while rescue teams continued efforts to save two others trapped under the debris.

Thousands of Warkari pilgrims travelling to Pandharpur were advised to avoid the Alandi route in Pune district because of severe flooding.

Southern Gujarat remained among the worst-hit regions, with Surat district recording five rain-related deaths over the last two days. Officials said two people died from electrocution on Tuesday; another person died in Kamrej, while two electrocution deaths had been reported earlier in Surat's Rander area.

Surat Municipal Commissioner M Nagarajan said around 2,100 people had been shifted from flood-prone areas to safer locations across different parts of the city.

The IMD said isolated places in Surat, Valsad and Dadra and Nagar Haveli received extremely heavy rainfall during the past 24 hours.

Arunachal Pradesh also witnessed fresh flooding and landslides as heavy rain continued across several districts. Changlang district reported flooding and a landslide, Upper Subansiri recorded two flood incidents and three landslides, while Upper Siang witnessed 16 landslides in just 24 hours. A rockfall caused by continuous rain was also reported in East Kameng district.

According to the State Emergency Operation Centre, more than 94,200 people across 333 villages in 237 circles covering 26 districts have been affected during the current monsoon season. Four people have died, 21 have been injured and two women remain

missing in recent floods and landslides. Rescue and relief operations are continuing.

Rain also spread across northern India. Delhi received moderate to heavy showers, with Najafgarh recording 76 mm of rainfall by Tuesday afternoon. The showers caused waterlogging and tree-fall incidents but brought relief from oppressive humidity after the capital recorded its highest minimum temperature for July since 2024. The IMD issued a yellow alert for thunderstorms and rain in Delhi on Wednesday and predicted increased rainfall activity across north India over the next three days.

In Haryana, Gurugram received 80 mm of rain, leading to the collapse of a section of the Delhi-Jaipur Highway near Narsinghpur, forcing the closure of two lanes. Civil Line Road also caved in, leaving two parked cars partially trapped.

Rainfall was also recorded across Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Himachal Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir, where authorities warned of possible flash floods, landslides and mudslides in vulnerable areas. In contrast, Rajasthan remained largely hot and dry, with Sriganganagar recording the state's highest temperature at 42.8 degrees Celsius.

Road caves in on Gurugram

Another vehicle was caught in a cave-in outside the residences of the Gurugram Deputy Commissioner and Haryana Cabinet Minister Rao Narbir.

Heavy rain, measured at 82 mm during the day, caused widespread waterlogging, slowing traffic on several major roads, including Basai, Hero Honda Chowk, Rajiv Chowk and Golf Course Extension Road. Long queues of cars, buses and trucks were seen moving through flooded stretches. The Delhi Police advised commuters heading towards Jaipur to plan for delays, use the Urban Extension Road-Dwarka Expressway route where possible and follow speed limits near the affected area. Authorities also directed motorists to use the Southern Peripheral Road via Rajiv Chowk or Hero Honda Chowk as alternate routes while repair work and traffic management continued. MPOST

Three tankers

appeared to be on hold until after the burial of Iran's Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who was killed at the beginning of the war. Mourners at his funeral have called for the death of US President Donald Trump.

Authorities flew Khamenei's body to the Shiite seminary city of Qom, where mourners honoured

him Tuesday. The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations centre said the tanker was hit near Limah, Oman, in the strait. The UKMTO said the projectile hit the port side of the vessel as it tried to travel south out of the strait toward the Gulf of Oman.

The agency said there were no environmental effects from the strike and that authorities were investigating.

Iranian state TV, quoting anonymous sources, implied that Tehran carried out the assault on a tanker it said was carrying natural gas from Qatar. However, there was no official claim from the Islamic Republic for the attack.

Majed Al-Ansari, a spokesperson for the Qatari Foreign Ministry, said targeting the Qatari tanker, Al Rekayyat, in the strait was an "unacceptable attack" on international navigation and global energy security. He called it a "serious and explicit violation" of international law.

In a post on X, he said Qatar holds Iran "fully legally responsible" for the attack.

Iran's joint military command warned last Thursday that all oil tankers moving through the strait must use its approved routes. It also said that interference by US forces in the strait "will be met with a rapid and decisive reaction." But the Joint Maritime Information Centre, a multinational body overseen by the US Navy, told shippers Monday that the route around Oman "has been expanded and remains available for all traffic."

Speaking Monday at the White House, Trump warned Iran that it would need to "make a deal, or we're going to finish the job."

"I'd rather make a deal, because I don't want to affect 91 million people," Trump said. "We can knock down their bridges in one hour. We can knock out their energy supply."

Iran and the United States agreed as part of an interim deal to allow ships to pass without paying charges for 60 days. But Tehran insisted it must control the routes of the vessels and later charge fees for passage, which would upend decades of practice in the waterway.

The US and many Gulf Arab states say they will not agree to Iran charging for passage through the strait. An effort by Oman and a United Nations agency to launch a new route near Oman's shore earlier sparked attacks across the Mideast.

The data firm Kpler reported that over last weekend at least 108 ships crossed through the strait using various routes.

HC order

"Since NEET is already over, the primary concern is no longer of any relevance. In these circumstances, the order is revoked."

Represented by senior advocate Akhil Sibal, Dipke argued

that the CJP account was a satirical platform protected under Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution. The petition said authorities should have blocked only specific posts, if necessary, instead of suspending the entire account. It also alleged violations of natural justice and the safeguards under Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, claiming no prior notice or reasons were provided.

On May 29, the court had declined immediate restoration and instead directed a review committee under the IT Rules to decide the matter before July 7.

Launched on May 16 after controversy over remarks by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, the CJP gained rapid online attention. After its original account was withheld, it continued through a new X handle, "Cockroach is Back", which has more than 2.8 lakh followers. The group says it represents a youth-led movement seeking accountability over the alleged NEET-UG 2026 paper leak and has been protesting at Jantar Mantar for 18 days, demanding Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation.

SIT report flags security

"The limited availability of CCTV footage has made it impossible to determine the number of theft incidents and the actual amount embezzled," the report notes.

The SIT has also fixed responsibility on counting room in-charge Subhash Srivastava, saying the money was allegedly siphoned off in his presence. A case has been registered against him as well.

The report says the crime became possible because prescribed security measures were not implemented. It points to failures in enforcing entry protocols, frisking of staff, prescribed dress codes, restrictions on carrying personal belongings, denomination-wise recording of cash and effective supervision of the counting process.

Investigators have observed that despite the presence of representatives of the trust and the bank during the counting exercise, security procedures were not effectively enforced.

The report raises questions over the monitoring of CCTV cameras in the counting room, saying the theft could have been detected and prevented if trust-appointed personnel had vigilantly watched the live footage during the counting process.

The SIT has also criticised the decision to preserve CCTV footage for only 45 days despite an earlier recommendation to maintain records for at least 180 days. It said handling and counting of temple donations was a highly sensitive activity and a longer

retention period was necessary.

The report also points to lapses on the part of the bank associated with the counting process. According to investigators, counting personnel were not provided the prescribed uniforms and the provision for monthly rotation of bank officials overseeing the counting exercise was not followed.

The preliminary findings also indicate that rules governing supervision of the counting process had been diluted. An SOP prepared on February 6, 2025 had laid down detailed procedures regarding access to the counting room, entry and exit of counting personnel, dress code and mandatory frisking before and after counting. However, the report says these norms were subsequently relaxed, enabling the accused to exploit the loopholes.

The SIT has described it as a matter of concern and further investigation as to under what circumstances these monitoring rules were altered.

The report specifically questions the supervisory role of trust member Dr Anil Mishra, who had been assigned responsibility for management of donations and offerings on September 20, 2024. It says that after the SOP came into force, it was his responsibility to ensure its implementation and review compliance, but there was a lack of continuous monitoring and oversight. Notably, the preliminary report does not mention trust general secretary Champat Rai or trustee Gopal Rao, prompting questions over whether they have been given a clean chit or whether their roles are still under examination.

The SIT has clarified that this is only an initial report and that the investigation is continuing. A final report will contain detailed findings on supervisory failures, administrative accountability, institutional shortcomings and recommendations for corrective measures.

The findings are likely to intensify calls for greater transparency and stronger financial controls in the management of donations at the Ram Temple, one of the country's most prominent religious institutions.

Enrolment in govt schools

The total number of schools also recorded a slight decline, falling from 14.72 lakh in 2023-24 to 14.67 lakh in 2025-26. At the same time, the number of teachers increased from 98.08 lakh to 1,02,73,020, improving the national pupil-teacher ratio from 25:1 to 24:1.

The report also pointed to improvements in school staffing. Zero-enrolment schools came down from 12,954 to 5,663, while the number of single-teacher schools declined from 1.11 lakh

to 1.01 lakh. Student retention improved at the middle and secondary stages. The middle-level retention rate rose from 82.8 per cent in 2024-25 to 83.7 per cent in 2025-26, while the secondary-level retention rate increased from 47.2 per cent to 51.9 per cent.

However, the report noted a slight decline in retention at the foundational and preparatory stages in 2025-26 after three consecutive years of improvement between 2022-23 and 2024-25.

Iran thanks India

and People's Democratic Party chief Mehbooba Mufti, former External Affairs Minister Salman Khurshid and religious leaders representing different faiths.

The embassy described India's participation as "a precious testament to the enduring ties" between the two countries and said it would provide "a valuable foundation for further strengthening the longstanding friendship" between Iran and India. It also thanked Indian officials, public figures and citizens who conveyed condolences after Khamenei's death.

Iran's statement followed a July 3 report by the semi-official Tasnim News Agency, affiliated with the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, which claimed the funeral became the focus of a diplomatic campaign led by Washington. Citing a senior Iranian source, Tasnim alleged that US Secretary of State Marco Rubio and American ambassadors urged governments to avoid sending official delegations to Tehran, warning that attendance could be viewed as an "unfriendly act" and could affect bilateral relations or development assistance.

Tasnim reported that at least 13 countries, including three Eastern European nations, five African states, two Persian Gulf Arab countries and two major East Asian nations, either withdrew or reduced their representation. It did not identify the countries. The report also claimed Rubio personally contacted at least five Arab governments. Neither the US State Department nor Rubio had publicly responded to the allegations at the time of writing.

Persian Gulf scholar Mehran Haghiriyan wrote on X that Saudi Arabia, Qatar and Oman sent official delegations, while the United Arab Emirates, Kuwait and Bahrain did not. India maintained its participation despite the reported diplomatic tensions, reflecting its longstanding policy of engaging with multiple partners across West Asia. The funeral in Tehran drew delegations from dozens of countries before ceremonies were scheduled to continue in Qom, followed by visits to the Iraqi holy cities of Najaf and Karbala and a final procession in Mashhad. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

MODI AT A DIASPORA EVENT IN JAKARTA

India’s self-reliance multiplying force for all ASEAN region: PM

JAKARTA: India is moving forward with the mantra of “reform, perform and transform,” Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Tuesday, as he underlined that the country’s self-reliance is a multiplying force not only for Indonesia but for the entire ASEAN region.

Speaking at a diaspora event in Jakarta attended by President Prabowo Subianto and his top ministers, Modi told the Indonesian leader that he is a “true friend of India.”

“India has carried out one reform after another. We have consistently performed, and that’s why the country is transforming today. We are moving forward with the mantra of reform, perform and transform,” Modi told the gathering.

Modi said if he had to describe the speed and scale of India’s growth in one line, he’d say, “1.4 billion aspirations in motion.”

“India is not just the world’s fastest-growing economy. India is a nation with a billion-plus dreams in motion,” he said, adding that India’s economy is playing a major role in driving global growth.

“From energy to connectivity and chip manufacturing, India is



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a session of the Indonesian Parliament, in Indonesia

unstoppable. Today’s India is not just fulfilling its own dreams, but also fulfilling the dreams of every friendly nation. India follows the mantra of ‘Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas,’ he said.

The Prime Minister said that India’s self-reliance is a multiplying force not only for Indonesia but for the entire ASEAN region.

As India is modernising its ports, building new ships and exploring new sea routes to strengthen its maritime sector, Indonesia stands as our favourite friend, Modi said.

“Whether in Indonesia or India, our shared goal is development. We cannot afford to wait or stop,” he added.

Modi said India’s economy is playing a major role in driving the world’s growth. “When Corona struck the world, even then India’s economy did not come to a standstill. When a crisis unfolded in West Asia, even then India’s economy did not halt. We performed, and that is why India is transforming,” he said. Speaking on the occasion, President Prabowo said he was honoured to be the chief guest at India’s Republic Day in 2025, just three months after assuming office.

“Just before I made my state visit to India, I had a what is called a genome sequencing test. I tested my DNA and I found out

Highlights

- » Modi told the Indonesian leader that he is a “true friend of India
- » India is moving forward with the mantra of ‘reform, perform and transform,’ Modi said
- » Modi said India’s economy is playing a major role in driving the world’s growth

PTI

I had Indian DNA. And that’s why I think every time I hear some music, especially Indian music, I find my body moving,” he said.

He said he’s a friend of all Indians, but he is a “great admirer” of PM Modi and copied many of his policies.

“Indonesians must learn from the experience of India. Our civilisation and our culture are strongly influenced by Indian civilisation. Our language is around 50 per cent derived from Sanskrit. Many of our names are Sanskrit names. Therefore, there is this closeness, and we welcome more close cooperation,” he added.

AGENCIES

Environment ministry removes Bhupendra Yadav’s private secy

Union minister Yadav’s assistant private secretary and two additional private secretaries also removed

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In an unprecedented move, the Ministry of Environment has simultaneously removed Union minister Bhupendra Yadav’s private secretary, assistant private secretary, and two additional private secretaries.

Yadav’s private secretary was removed on “administrative grounds”, while the appointments of an assistant private secretary and an additional private secretary were terminated. The other additional private secretary was “prematurely repatriated” to his parent cadre.

The decision was announced through four different orders issued on July 3, which did not mention the reasons for the officials’ removal.

Yadav’s private secretary Amar Singh, who has been relieved, is a 2010 batch Indian Revenue Service officer. He was appointed to the post in June 2024, for a period up to September 7, 2026, according to a Department of Personnel and Training memorandum.

“Amar Singh IRS, private secretary to the Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, is repatriated to his

'Has Chanda Do Dhandha Lo' scheme gone awry: Congress slams govt

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Tuesday took a swipe at the government over the removal of key aides of Environment minister Bhupendra Yadav from his office, asking whether this could be an instance of the “Pradhan Mantri Chanda Do Dhandha Lo” scheme having gone wrong.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said the news of the sacking of four members of Yadav’s staff is shocking. The Opposition party’s dig came after the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change relieved the private secretary and three additional secretaries of their duties from Yadav’s office.

MPOST

parent cadre, that is the Department of Revenue, on administrative grounds and relieved of his duties with immediate effect,” the environment ministry’s order read.

Siddharth Yadav is the assistant private secretary whose appointment has been terminated with immediate effect. The additional private secretary whose appointment has been terminated is Ayush Saran.

“In pursuance of the Department of Personnel and Training’s OM (official memorandum), and with the approval of the competent authority, the appointment of Ayush Saran as additional private secretary to the Minister for

Environment, Forest and Climate Change is terminated with immediate effect. Ayush Saran is relieved of his duties immediately,” said the order.

Additional Private Secretary Shailesh Kumar Singh has been repatriated to his parent cadre.

“Shailesh Kumar Singh, Central Secretariat Service, additional private secretary to the Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, is prematurely repatriated to his parent cadre, that is the Department of Personnel and Training, with the provision of ‘extended cooling off’ and relieved of his duties with immediate effect,” read the order.

Offered Rs 30 cr to join DMK, received death threats, claims TVK MLA

OUR CORRESPONDENT

TUTICORIN: TVK MLA from Srivaikuntam constituency, G Saravanan, has alleged that he was offered massive financial inducements ranging from Rs 30 crore to Rs 100 crore to defect the ruling party and join the DMK, and that he was issued death threats if he refused to comply.

Addressing journalists at his party office, the legislator asserted that he has concrete evidence regarding these “horse-trading” attempts.

“Several individuals have approached me directly offering immense sums of money. They said we will give you Rs 30 crore, Rs 50 crore, or even Rs 100 crore. Just join the DMK.

When I refused, they resorted to harassment and open death threats, warning me that they would eliminate me if I did not comply,” he claimed.

He further added that because he rose from a humble, grassroots background to become an MLA, these elements assumed he could be easily intimidated or bought.

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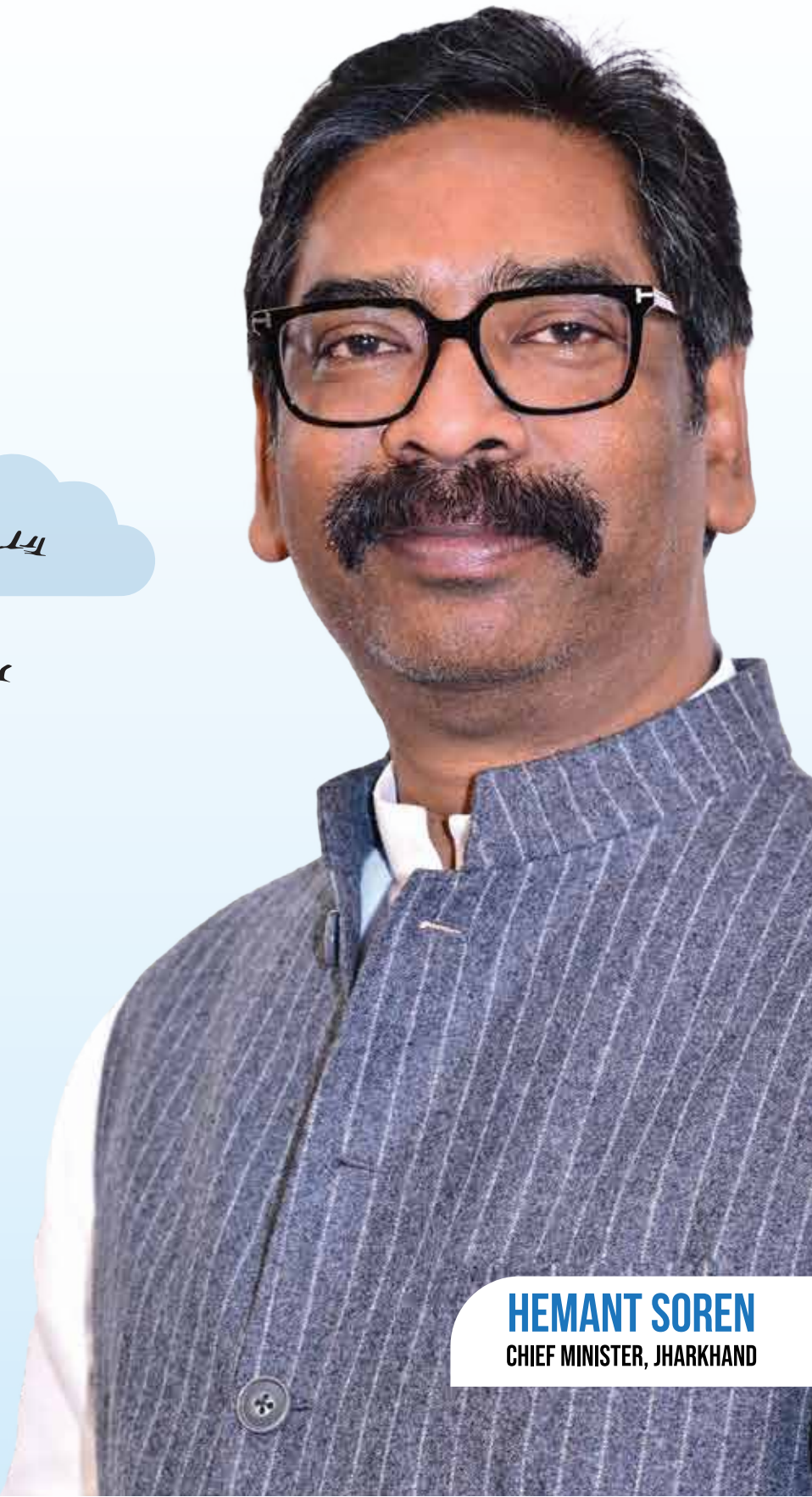
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HEMANT SOREN
CHIEF MINISTER, JHARKHAND

MEMBERS ADOPT ‘GUWAHATI DECLARATION’

BRICS nations step up fight against narcotics

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GUWAHATI: BRICS nations adopted the ‘Guwahati Declaration’ to consolidate efforts in the fight against illicit drug trafficking and international organised crime after two days of the BRICS Heads of Anti-Drug Agencies Meeting in Guwahati on Tuesday.

The Joint Declaration reiterated the need for the timely exchange of information and intelligence, as well as innovative technologies, strategies, data and best practices, in accordance with applicable legislation and international obligations, for countering drug trafficking and transnational organised crime. Notably, the member states expressed concern about the increasing use of synthetic drugs and New Psychoactive Substances (NPS) and diversion of precursors through emerg-



Dignitaries pose for the camera during the BRICS Heads of Anti-Drug Agencies Meeting in Guwahati on Tuesday MPOST

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The Declaration reiterated need for timely exchange of information and intelligence, as well as innovative technologies, strategies, & best practices
- » The declaration also emphasises the need

to scale up demand reduction measures, including promoting healthy lifestyles and protecting vulnerable populations

» Director General of NCB Anurag Garg said India is committed to developing a partnership with like-minded countries

India’s Director General of Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) Anurag Garg, while addressing the plenary session comprising heads of anti-drug agencies of BRICS nations, said India is committed to developing a partnership with like-minded countries based on speed, synergy, and shared information for timely actions against international drug-trafficking networks, threatening the security of nations. He stressed India’s zero-tolerance policy against drugs and the Narcotics Control Vision Document 2026-29, which prioritises disrupting criminal networks, reducing abuse through awareness and treatment, de-addiction and rehabilitation programs.

“In his closing remarks, DG NCB suggested setting up a BRICS Virtual Working Group and enhanced training mod-

ules for members to facilitate better coordination and cooperation among agencies,” the release said.

The meeting provided a platform for members to deliberate and discuss the national situation on illicit drug use, trafficking and abuse, as well as hold thematic sessions on trafficking through the dark web, use of digital technologies for drug interdiction, emerging psychoactive substances and measures for the prevention of precursor chemical diversion.

The meeting was organised under India’s 2026 BRICS chairmanship theme: “Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.” It was attended by delegates from Brazil, China, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Iran, Russia, and the UAE, who emphasised consolidating efforts to achieve a drug-free and safer world.

Narmada payment dispute ‘resolved’; four states ink pact

Pact reflects cooperative federalism: HM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

INSIGHT

- » The settlement ends the long-pending dispute over cost-sharing for the Sardar Sarovar Project
- » Shah said disputes between states were being resolved more quickly under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi

NEW DELHI: Maharashtra, Gujarat, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh on Tuesday signed a historic agreement to resolve a decades-old dispute over delayed payments under the Narmada Project, in the presence of Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah and Union Jal Shakti Minister C.R. Patil.

The agreement was signed by Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma and Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, along with senior officials from the Centre and the four states.

The settlement ends the long-pending dispute over cost-sharing for the Sardar Sarovar Project, with the four states agreeing to a one-time settlement of the outstanding dues. Speaking on the occasion, Shah said the agreement marked the resolution of a long-standing issue among the beneficiary states of the Sardar Sarovar Project and reflected the spirit of cooperative federalism. He said disputes between states were being resolved more quickly under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Shah said the Sardar Sarovar Project had significantly benefited Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat and Rajasthan by providing irrigation, drinking water and electricity. Referring to Rajasthan’s relatively smaller share in the project, he said the state had gained not only through irrigation but also from the electricity generated by the dam.

The Home minister commended the four states for

resolving the issue through consensus and lauded the Ministry of Jal Shakti for facilitating the agreement. He added that inter-state water disputes were now being settled more expeditiously, citing the recent resolution of the water-sharing issue between Haryana and Rajasthan as an example.

Emphasising the importance of cooperation in water management, Shah said water resources ultimately benefit farmers irrespective of state boundaries. He added that reservoirs and other water infrastructure created through such projects are valuable national assets and stressed that water-sharing disputes should be resolved promptly to prevent the wastage of precious natural resources.

Recently, significant progress has also been made in resolving long-standing water-sharing issues between states, such as those concerning the Kishau Dam project in Himachal Pradesh and the water dispute between Rajasthan and Haryana. On June 29, Rajasthan and Haryana signed an agreement for the construction and implementation of the Yamuna Water Project, resolving a nearly three-decade-old issue.

CBI files first chargesheet in Rs 4,097-crore RCFL fraud case

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The CBI on Tuesday filed its first chargesheet in the alleged Rs 4,097-crore bank fraud involving Reliance Commercial Finance Limited (RCFL), naming seven accused, including two Reliance group companies and five former senior executives, before a Special CBI Court in Mumbai.

The chargesheet names Reliance Infrastructure Ltd, Reliance Home Finance Limited (RHFL), Devang Pravin Mody (former Director and CEO), Ravindra Somayajula Rao (Director), Dhananjay Bhagwanprasad Tiwari (Director), Rajesh Krishnamoorthy (Executive Risk Officer) and Lav Chaturvedi (Chief Risk Officer). According to the CBI, its

investigation found that loans availed by RCFL from a consortium of 13 public sector banks were allegedly diverted to the Reliance ADA Group through various intermediaries and conduit entities in violation of the terms and conditions of the loan agreements. The agency alleged that the diversion of funds and subsequent defaults caused a wrongful loss of Rs 4,097 crore to the consortium banks while benefiting the accused and others.

The case was registered on complaints filed by the Bank of Maharashtra and other consortium member banks that had extended credit facilities to RCFL. The CBI said further investigation is underway to ascertain the role of other directors, companies and pub-

lic servants in the alleged fraud. Separately, the agency has arrested Amitabh Jhunjhunwala, former Vice Chairman of Reliance Capital Ltd, Devang Pravin Mody, former CEO of RCFL, and Amit Bapna, former Chief Financial Officer of Reliance Capital Ltd, Jhunjhunwala and Mody are in judicial custody, while Bapna remains in CBI custody.

The RCFL case marks the second chargesheet filed by the CBI in connection with alleged financial irregularities involving companies of the Reliance ADA Group. Earlier, on May 29, 2026, the agency filed a chargesheet in the Reliance Communications (RCom) case, the investigation of which has been closely monitored by the Supreme Court.

including promoting healthy lifestyles and protecting vulnerable populations, particularly children and youth.

Ladakh LG clears ‘pro-people’ interim land-use framework

LEH: Ladakh Lieutenant Governor V K Saxena on Tuesday approved an interim land-use regulatory framework allowing the use of plots up to two kanals within Municipal Committee limits for residential, commercial, industrial or mixed-use purposes without prior approval.

However, prohibited activities without prior approval include Red and Orange category industries in commercial areas; Red, Orange and Green category industries, slaughterhouses, commercial animal rearing, stone quarries, storage of inflammable materials, and burial grounds or crematoria in residential and mixed-use areas, an official spokesperson said.

The approved framework was aimed at removing long-

standing uncertainty over land use and ensuring that citizens do not face hardship in obtaining building permissions, in the absence of notified Master Plans in Ladakh, he said.

He said the decision addresses a major regulatory gap that existed due to the absence of notified Master Plans and Zonal Development Plans, under which there was no clearly defined distinction regarding the nature of activities – residential, commercial, industrial or mixed-use – that could be undertaken on land within municipal areas.

This often resulted in uncertainty for citizens seeking building permissions and undertaking legitimate developmental activities, the spokesperson said. Recognising the

inconvenience being faced by the people, the Lt Governor intervened to establish a transparent, demand-driven interim framework that enables development while ensuring proper regulation, until statutory planning instruments are notified.

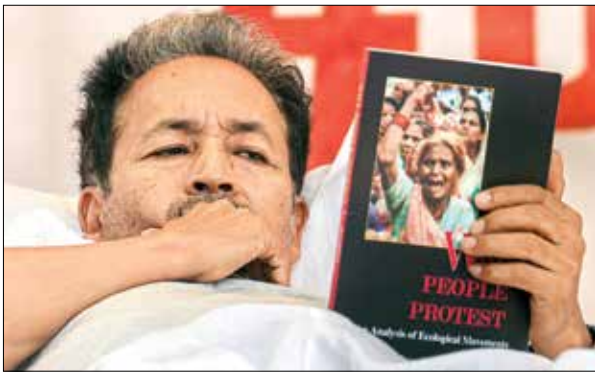
“Planned urban development is essential for the long-term growth and sustainability of Ladakh. At the same time, the absence of notified Master Plans should not become a hurdle for citizens seeking to construct homes, establish businesses or undertake legitimate developmental activities. This interim framework balances developmental needs with environmental safeguards and provides much-needed regulatory clarity until the Master Plans are finalised,” the Lt Governor said. MPOST

Day 10 of fast: Wangchuk’s BP ‘quite low’

Dipke hails Delhi High Court’s order unblocking CJP’s X handle

NEW DELHI: The Cockroach Janta Party on Tuesday welcomed a Delhi High Court order to unblock its original X handle, as its protest at the Jantar Mantar demanding Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan’s resignation and government accountability for exam “irregularities” entered its 18th day, with activist Sonam Wangchuk completing the 10th day of his indefinite hunger strike in support of the demands.

Addressing a press conference, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke said Wangchuk had lost more than six kgs since beginning the fast, with his blood pressure remaining “quite low”. “It is deeply unfortunate that someone like Sonam Wangchuk has been on a hunger strike for days, yet the government refuses to act. It is difficult to understand how a



government can be so ignorant,” Dipke said.

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday ordered the restoration of the Cockroach Janta Party’s (CJP) original X handle after the Centre informed it that the account had been withheld to prevent “chaos” ahead of the NEET-UG re-test on June 21, and that there would be no difficulty revoking it now.

protest,” Wangchuk said.

Dipke termed the court order a “big win” not just for the CJP and the movement, but also for free speech and digital rights.

Questioning the Centre’s stand before the court, Dipke said the government had initially claimed that the CJP posed a threat to national security but later told the court that its account was blocked because its posts could create unrest among students and parents during the NEET re-examination.

“Such contradictory statements are absurd in the first place. Our account should have been blocked had we posted anything wrong or illegal. But all we did was raise the voice of the youth. Blocking our account without any warning was completely unjustified,” Dipke said. MPOST

ED searches 5 Carewell Group-linked premises

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Monday conducted searches at five premises linked to the Carewell Group in connection with an alleged money laundering case involving the misappropriation and illegal collection of funds related to AITC.

The searches are part of an investigation into the alleged transfer of nearly Rs 160 crore from AITC to Carewell Aviation India Pvt. Ltd. and its related entities between April 2023 and June 2026. According to the ED, the funds were routed through multiple bank accounts to conceal their actual source and destination.

The agency alleged that around Rs 82.96 crore was subsequently transferred from Carewell Aviation India Pvt. Ltd. to a newly incorporated related entity during the 2023-2026 period.

The ED said its investigation found that a substantial portion of the funds received by Carewell Aviation India Pvt. Ltd. was used to purchase an Embraer Legacy 600 aircraft and an Agusta 109 SP helicopter valued at nearly Rs 112 crore. It alleged that while part of the money used to acquire the helicopter came from overseas sources, the bulk of the funding originated from AITC.

According to the agency, despite being acquired using AITC’s funds, both the aircraft and the helicopter were leased back to the company, which also made substantial payments for their use.

The ED further alleged that the transactions formed part of a complex chain designed to conceal the actual beneficiaries and purpose of the payments. It said the searches were carried out to gather documentary and electronic evidence to trace the flow of funds and determine whether the transactions violated the provisions of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002.

The investigation is continuing.

Haryana committed to building strong sports culture: CM Saini

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday said the state government is committed to building a strong sports culture by ensuring that talent gets opportunities and athletes receive recognition for their achievements.

Addressing a cash award distribution ceremony in Panchkula, Saini distributed Rs 20.59 crore to 198 sportspersons for their achievements at international and national competitions. According to an official statement, Rs 13.75 crore was awarded to 117 athletes for international performances, Rs 2.32 crore to three medallists at the 2022 Para Asian Games and Rs 4.52 crore to 78 national-level sportspersons.

Congratulating the awardees, the CM said every medal reflects years of hard work, discipline and determination.



He noted that Haryana, with nearly two per cent of India’s population, contributes more than one-third of the country’s medals at major international sporting events. Over the past 12 years, the state has distributed nearly Rs 730 crore as cash incentives to 17,182 athletes, including the latest awards.

Highlighting government initiatives, Saini said 260 sportspersons have secured government jobs under the Outstanding Sportspersons Recruitment Rules, while the sports gradation policy has been expanded to include par-

ticipants in the Haryana State Games. Monthly honorariums for recipients of the Khel Ratna, Dronacharya, Arjuna, Dhyan Chand and Tenzing Norgay awards have been increased to Rs 20,000, while Bhim Award winners now receive Rs 5,000 per month.

The CM said Haryana has established 2,000 sports nurseries, provides monthly scholarships of Rs 1,500 to Rs 2,000 for athletes aged 8-19 years and offers a daily diet allowance of Rs 500 to trainees at 25 residential sports academies. He added that the state has invested Rs 1,100 crore in sports infrastructure over the past 12 years, with the sports budget rising from Rs 163 crore in 2013-14 to Rs 668.42 crore. He also highlighted North’s first A-star scientific training and rehabilitation centre at Tau Devi Lal Sports Complex, Panchkula. MPOST

Mumbai floods: Climate change ‘altering’ Indian monsoon’s behaviour, say experts

‘Rapidly strengthening El Nino in Pacific delays onset of monsoon’

NEW DELHI: El Nino, the recurrent weather pattern that drives up global temperatures, and climate change cannot be viewed independently as one is delaying the rains and the other intensifying them, according to climate experts.

A rapidly strengthening El Nino in the Pacific delayed the onset of the monsoon and kept rainfall subdued through June, leaving India with a 40 per cent rainfall deficit by the end of the month. Yet, within days, the scenario changed dramatically. As the monsoon entered an active phase by the end of June, Mumbai and large parts of India’s West Coast were battered by exceptionally intense rainfall.

Experts say the new reality that climate change is fundamentally altering the behaviour of the Indian monsoon.

“Monsoon is presently in an active phase, with several weather systems prevailing across the country. There was a depression over Odisha and a cyclonic circulation over Maharashtra, keeping the western

KEY POINTS

- » Experts say the new reality that climate change is fundamentally altering the behaviour of the Indian monsoon
- » Scientists emphasise that El Nino and climate



change can no longer be viewed independently

and eastern arms of monsoon active,” said Mahesh Palawat, Vice President - Meteorology and Climate Change, Skymet Weather. “Along with this, continuous moisture feed from the Arabian Sea led to continuous regeneration of clouds over Maharashtra in the last three-four days, leading to heavy rainfall,” Palawat said.

Raghu Murtugudde, Emeritus Professor, University of Maryland and retired professor, IIT-Mumbai, explained that Mumbai saw delayed onset of monsoon which is partly explainable by El Nino.

“But the global warming pattern of warm Western Asia and shifted Arabian Sea winds have kicked in as expected. Lots

of winds as well, which is part of the larger heavy rain over the core monsoon zone. Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal are both feeding heavy rain in the interior. El Nino just cannot be separated from global warming anymore. “Both the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal are active, and a low-pressure system is also starting from the Bay of Bengal. When this happens and both sides fire up, the core monsoon zone gets heavy rain and that moisture supply also goes over Mumbai. Western Ghats force air to climb, so Mumbai gets lots of rain,” Murtugudde said.

While three-digit rainfall in Mumbai and places along the West Coast are common

during the monsoon season, meteorologists suggest that there has been a significant rise in such deluge-like spells during July and August across Maharashtra, Gujarat, South Rajasthan and Southwest Madhya Pradesh. Scientists emphasise that El Nino and climate change can no longer be viewed independently.

While El Nino influences monsoon circulation and often reduces the number of rainy days, record warming of the Arabian Sea and changing atmospheric circulation are increasing moisture availability, allowing weather systems to produce much heavier rainfall once conditions become favourable.

“El Nino is delaying the rains while climate change is intensifying them. Monsoon dynamics have changed over the last few years, which can be directly linked with climate change. Weather systems forming in the Bay of Bengal have been travelling in the west direction, instead of northwest,” Palawat said. AGENCIES

Ladakh: Asst engineer held for ‘misappropriation’ of BRO funds

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested an assistant engineer (civil) of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) and two labour supply agents in Kargil for allegedly misappropriating BRO funds in Ladakh.

The arrested engineer was posted as Officer In-charge of the Khatse-Batalik Sector under the 81 Road Construction Company (RCC).

According to the CBI, he colluded with the two contractors to siphon off funds by preparing fake workmen lists and releasing payments that were later credited to the contractors’ accounts.

The agency has registered four FIRs based on complaints from the Ministry of Defence alleging corruption, criminal negligence, conspiracy, cheating, breach of trust and forgery. It has also conducted searches at 26 locations across several states, besides another search in Himachal Pradesh. The accused will be produced before a court in Ladakh, while the investigation is continuing. MPOST

2008 AHMEDABAD BLASTS Gujarat HC upholds death penalty for 38 IM operatives

AHMEDABAD: The Gujarat High Court on Tuesday upheld a special court order that pronounced death sentences for 38 operatives of the terror outfit Indian Mujahideen (IM) and life imprisonment for 11 others in the 2008 Ahmedabad serial blasts, which claimed 56 lives.

The special court’s February 2022 order marked the first time that so many convicts had been handed down the death sentence by any court at one go.

The convicts include Safdar Nagori, former leader of the banned outfit Student Islamic Movement of India (SIMI), and his associates.

The high court also directed the state government to pay compensation of Rs 10 lakh to the kin of those who died in the serial blasts and Rs 5 lakh to those who were grievously injured.

A division bench of justices A Y Kogte and Samir Dave rejected all appeals against the order of the lower court and upheld its verdict confirming the sentences to members of the terror outfit Indian Mujahideen in the case.

On July 26, 2008, a series of



21 bomb blasts ripped through different areas of Ahmedabad in a span of 70 minutes, killing 56 persons and leaving more than 200 others injured. Explosions also struck hospitals in the city as blast victims from other places were being rushed in for treatment — marking the first time medical facilities were targeted in such an attack.

Seventy-eight persons were put on trial before the special court, and of them, 49 were convicted in February 2022. The trial was conducted after merging 35 different police cases, 20 FIRs lodged in Ahmedabad for 21 blasts and 15 in Surat city, where the terrorists had placed bombs, but they did not detonate.

The special court in February 2022 sentenced 38 IM members to death and 11 others to life imprisonment. MPOST



EDITORIAL
FREEDOM
FIRST

The Delhi High Court's decision to restore the X handle of the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) may appear, at first glance, to concern a single social media account. In reality, it raises much larger constitutional questions about the relationship between free speech, state power and digital platforms in contemporary India. The Centre informed the court that the account had been withheld to prevent "chaos" among students and parents ahead of the NEET re-test, adding that the concern no longer existed once the examination was over. On that basis, the government itself expressed no objection to the account being restored, and the court directed that it be unblocked. The immediate controversy may have ended, but the legal and democratic questions it has exposed remain unresolved. Can the executive temporarily silence an online voice whenever it anticipates public unrest? What threshold must be met before an entire account, rather than specific offending content, is blocked? Most importantly, who decides where legitimate preventive action ends and disproportionate censorship begins?

India's Constitution guarantees freedom of speech and expression under Article 19(1)(a), while Article 19(2) permits reasonable restrictions in narrowly defined circumstances such as public order, national security and incitement to offences. The operative word, however, is "reasonable". Courts have repeatedly held that restrictions must satisfy the tests of legality, necessity and proportionality. In the digital age, these principles acquire even greater significance because online platforms have become central spaces for political participation, public debate and civic mobilisation. Blocking an entire account is no longer equivalent to removing a poster from a wall; it effectively erases a speaker from one of the country's most influential public forums. The petitioners argued that if individual posts violated the law, those posts could have been removed instead of disabling the entire account. That argument reflects an increasingly accepted principle in constitutional jurisprudence worldwide: restrictions should be narrowly tailored and should interfere with fundamental rights only to the minimum extent necessary. Blanket restrictions should remain exceptional rather than routine.

The legal framework governing such actions also deserves closer scrutiny. Section 69A of the Information Technology Act empowers the government to block online content in the interests of sovereignty, security, defence, public order and other specified grounds. The provision was upheld by the Supreme Court in *Shreya Singhal v. Union of India* (2015), but only because it contained procedural safeguards, including recorded reasons, review mechanisms and limited circumstances for its exercise. Yet criticism of the blocking regime has persisted. Orders issued under Section 69A are generally confidential, affected users often receive little or no prior notice, and opportunities to challenge executive decisions are frequently available only after the restriction has already taken effect. Transparency remains limited despite repeated calls by civil society and legal scholars for greater disclosure. The present case again illustrates the tension between executive discretion and procedural fairness. If the government's concern was confined to examination-related misinformation, the question naturally arises whether a less restrictive alternative could have achieved the same objective without silencing an entire political satire movement.

The emergence of the Cockroach Janta Party also reflects a broader global trend in digital politics. Satire has always been a powerful instrument of democratic expression because it allows citizens to criticise authority through symbolism, irony and humour. Around the world, protest movements have often embraced labels initially intended as insults and transformed them into badges of resistance. Social media has amplified this phenomenon by enabling decentralised communities to organise rapidly around shared narratives. Whether one agrees with the CJP's methods or political objectives is ultimately irrelevant from a constitutional standpoint. Democracies do not protect only agreeable speech; they are tested by their willingness to protect speech that is provocative, uncomfortable or sharply critical of those in power. If governments begin suppressing satire merely because it attracts large audiences or mobilises dissent, they risk weakening the very democratic culture they seek to preserve. At the same time, this does not imply that digital platforms should become lawless spaces. Deliberate misinformation capable of disrupting examinations or inciting violence deserves prompt and proportionate intervention. The challenge lies in distinguishing harmful conduct from legitimate political expression without allowing subjective administrative judgments to become instruments of censorship.

The Delhi High Court's order should therefore be viewed as more than the restoration of a social media handle. It offers an opportunity to reconsider how India governs online speech in an era where digital platforms have become indispensable democratic spaces. The government's explanation that the restriction was temporary and examination-specific may well have been genuine. Yet exceptional powers exercised during moments of perceived urgency often establish precedents that outlast the emergency itself. Democratic resilience depends not only on maintaining public order but also on preserving public trust that restrictions on speech will remain transparent, proportionate and subject to meaningful judicial oversight. India, as the world's largest democracy, has every reason to develop a digital governance model that protects both security and liberty instead of treating them as competing objectives. The constitutional promise of free expression cannot depend solely on the goodwill of the executive or the passage of time after a crisis has ended. It requires clear rules, procedural accountability and an unwavering commitment to the principle that even unpopular, satirical or inconvenient voices deserve protection unless they clearly cross the boundaries established by law. In the digital republic that India is rapidly becoming, safeguarding that balance will be one of the defining constitutional challenges of the coming decade.

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON,
BHARAT KI SOCH

He demonstrated that loyalty should never become blind obedience, and that speaking uncomfortable truths is a duty rather than an act of rebellion

DARK
INFLUENCERS

Content moderation and transaction surveillance are different disciplines, and progress on the first does not address the second

Courage to Speak the Truth

From the Mahabharat to modern governance, Vidur reminds us that institutions survive only when conscience guides power and truth remains heard



Vidur reminds leaders that wisdom has little value unless they possess the courage to act upon it

The tragedy of Dhritrashtra was not that he had no access to wisdom. It was that he lacked the courage to act on the wisdom placed before him. Vidur's counsel was available, but Dhritrashtra's attachment to Duryodhan overpowered his judgement. This is a timeless leadership lesson. Many leaders know the right course, but attachment, fear or insecurity becomes their real enemy. When emotion overrules judgement, even intelligent people make destructive choices. Institutions decline when emotions overpower judgement and when leaders choose comfort over correction. The wisdom associated with Vidur is remembered through Vidur Niti, a body of counsel on conduct, self-control, governance, justice, friendship, greed, anger and the duties of those in power. Its importance lies in its practicality. Vidur does not speak as a distant philosopher.

He speaks as someone who understands how people, families, courts and kingdoms collapse when judgement is clouded by ego. Vidur Niti reminds us that ethics are not ornamental. They are instruments of survival. Intelligence without self-mastery eventually fails. Knowledge becomes dangerous when it is not guided by restraint. A central moral value in Vidur's life is restraint. He was wise, but never arrogant. He was close to power, but never intoxicated by it. He could see further than most, but he did not use his intelligence to manipulate. This separates wisdom from cleverness. Cleverness can win arguments, exploit situations and secure short-term advantage. Wisdom protects balance, dignity and justice. Vidur's example shows that intellect becomes meaningful only when governed by conscience. His role during the attempted burning of the Pandavs at Lak-

shagriha shows the quiet power of ethical action. When danger was being planned in secrecy, Vidur understood the threat and warned Yudhishtir in a coded manner. He also helped create a path of escape. This was not dramatic heroism on the battlefield, but it was leadership of a very high order. He used intelligence to protect the innocent, not to strengthen the powerful. He acted with caution, foresight and responsibility. Vidur reminds us that leadership is not always loud. Sometimes it lies in timely warning, careful planning and the courage to prevent disaster before it unfolds.

The disrobing of Draupadi in the Kuru court remains one of the Mahabharat's most painful moments. In that assembly, many great warriors were present, yet moral courage was scarce. Vidur was among the few who condemned the injustice. His protest matters because it shows that silence in the face of wrongdoing is not neutrality. It becomes support for adharna. When institutions witness injustice and remain quiet, they lose their moral centre. Vidur's voice reminds us that ethics require speech, especially when silence is easier.

A kingdom is not destroyed only by weak armies. It is also destroyed when wise counsel is ignored, when inconvenient truth is silenced and when those in authority surround themselves with approval instead of judgement. This is one of the sharpest leadership lessons from Vidur's story. Dhritrashtra heard Vidur, but did not truly listen to him. He respected Vidur's wisdom, but allowed attachment to defeat action. Advice has value only when leaders have the humility to receive it and the courage to act upon it.

This lesson applies with equal force to modern institutions. Every boardroom needs someone who speaks uncomfortable truths. Every organisation needs people who can warn against excess, question weak assumptions and protect

long-term trust from short-term temptation. Growth without ethics may look successful for a time, but it becomes fragile. Ambition without restraint may produce immediate results, but it can damage credibility. Integrity means independent judgement and the courage to refuse compromises that may bring quick gain but weaken long-term trust.

As India moves towards the vision of Viksit Bharat, Vidur's lesson can be understood through the lens of institution-building and business leadership. A successful business ecosystem is built not only on infrastructure, enterprise, innovation and speed, but also on ethical decision-making, responsible leadership, fair processes and the courage to correct course before mistakes become crises. Progress becomes durable only when it is guided by conscience.

Vidur also teaches that leadership is not limited to formal authority. One can lead through advice, integrity, courage, restraint and example. A teacher who guides students honestly, an officer who refuses unfair pressure, a professional who speaks against wrongdoing, a parent who teaches values through conduct and a citizen who stands by fairness all carry forward the spirit of Vidur. Leadership begins wherever conscience refuses to remain silent.

In every age there are rulers, but only a few become civilisational voices. Vidur became one because he chose truth over power, conscience over convenience and dharma over fear. He reminds us that the strength of a society is not measured only by those who command, but also by those who counsel with integrity. His life teaches that leadership without ethics becomes fragile, wisdom without courage becomes silent and power without dharma eventually destroys itself. Vidur did not win kingdoms or command armies, yet his voice continues to endure because it was rooted in truth.

Views expressed are personal

When Algorithms Finance Extremism

FATF's latest findings reveal how social media influencers, digital payments and algorithms are reshaping terrorist financing in the internet age; write Smarak Swain & Kashyap Kompella

In a consultation paper released on 23 June, India's financial market regulator SEBI proposed regulating how investment advisors and stockbrokers hire and use "influencers", digital influencers who shape the investment decisions of ordinary people while pocketing undisclosed commissions from brokers. Three days later, the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) published a report that highlights how another class of influencers poses a different threat. Where the influencer compromises financial integrity, this one compromises national security.

According to FATF's report *Detecting and Disrupting Terrorist Financing Activity through Social Media, Instant Messaging Applications, and Streaming Platforms*, terrorists and their financiers are increasingly using a business model indistinguishable from that of mainstream creators to raise money for extremism. From Hawala to Hashtags

For decades, tracking terror funds was a manageable task for intelligence agencies. Terrorist networks relied on front charities to raise donations, on banking channels to move money, and on underground systems like hawala to transfer funds across borders without leaving a formal trail. These methods were not frictionless: Banking transactions generated records; hawala networks depended on intermediaries who could be monitored through human intelligence. Financial intelligence units and law enforcement could, eventually, identify and disrupt the flows.

Modern technology platforms have fundamentally altered this architecture. Today's social media, messaging, and streaming services are not only communication channels; they are full-fledged digital marketplaces equipped with in-app wallets, digital tipping, livestream monetisation, peer-to-peer transfer features, and embedded links to virtual assets. The line between a content platform and a payment platform has been blurred, although the compliance frameworks have not kept pace.

This shift creates a new vulnerability. Radical creators produce highly-charged



Radical creators produce highly-charged content and spread false narratives, targeting audiences most likely to be receptive

content and spread false narratives, targeting audiences most likely to be receptive. A creator does not need to physically interact with anyone to build a radicalised following. When a geopolitical conflict or humanitarian crisis creates the right emotional moment, these harmfulfluencers launch opportunistic digital fundraising drives, using the infrastructure already embedded in the platform.

Their revenue model runs on two tracks simultaneously. First, creators earn advertising income from the viewership that radicalising content attracts. Secondly, that newly (and already) radicalised audience becomes a source of donations. Artificial intelligence has accelerated both tracks by enabling higher volumes of targeted content at lower production cost. The result is a financing model that requires no front charity, no banking relationship, and no hawala intermediary.

The Micro-Donation Architecture Rather than soliciting large transfers that raise suspicion, these networks run on crowd-sourced micro-donations: individually small contributions that, in aggregate, amount to large capital for terrorist operations. For instance, UN-sanctioned organisations Lashkar-

e-Taiba and Jaish-e-Mohammed both pivoted toward micro-donation collection through social media platforms after their access to conventional financial channels was curtailed after sanctions enforcement.

The FATF report highlights that the method is deliberately layered. Fundraising campaigns begin on mainstream platforms to reach the widest possible audience. Once a follower shows active interest, they are redirected to private, encrypted channels where payment instructions consisting of temporary virtual asset wallet addresses, peer-to-peer transfer links, and mobile voucher codes are shared. By the time money moves, it has already left the content platform where the audience was cultivated and sits on a payment rail with no link to the content that generated the donation. Banks, which have the obligation to detect and flag suspicious transactions, only see a small transfer with no context.

The potential scale of this model is visible in JeM's fundraising efforts after the losses it sustained during Operation Sindoor. Proxy accounts and affiliated commanders posted appeals across social media platforms, and interested followers were redirected to a network of mule digital wallets hosted by Easypaisa

and Sadapay. The collection target was Rs. 3.91 billion, intended to rebuild terrorist infrastructure.

The Policy Blind Spot

The regulatory architecture has to keep pace with these shifts. Current compliance obligations on technology companies focus on content: a platform is required to take down material that constitutes a terrorist manifesto or a violent video. Content that inflames, radicalises, or amplifies extremist narratives without crossing that legal threshold is treated as a separate matter and it stays on the platform, and continues generating advertising revenue.

Global regulations track content and not money. Social media companies have invested heavily in AI to identify hate speech and extremist material, but not enough to monitor suspicious financial flows. FATF notes that the capacity to identify and disrupt accompanying financial flows is still being developed. Content moderation and transaction surveillance are different disciplines, and progress on the first does not address the second.

Building the response

Innovation should not be stifled, but when a "like" generates ad revenue for terrorists and a tipping feature can aggregate donations for a banned organisation, there is a case for treating these functionalities as regulated financial infrastructure. The question of where platform responsibility begins and payment provider responsibility ends is one that requires regulatory resolution.

SEBI's concern with financial influencers has correctly identified creator platforms as a space where financial activity and financial risk coexist with content. The influencer and the harmfulfluencer operate on the same infrastructure, use the same monetisation tools, and build their audiences through the same algorithmic dynamics. Both need financial intelligence, law enforcement, and platform supervisors working together.

S Swain is co-chair of FATF's working group on risks. K Kompella is an AI Governance expert. Views expressed are personal

AT LEAST 18 PEOPLE LOST THEIR LIVES

Blasts rock Damascus as Macron visits Syria



Syrian security personnel inspect a burned vehicles near the Four Seasons Hotel after two explosions rocked the area, in Damascus on Tuesday

DAMASCUS: Explosions rocked Syria's capital on Tuesday and injured at least 18 people as France's president met with his counterpart in a landmark visit to the country rebuilding from years of civil war, Syria's Interior Ministry said.

It was the second attack in Damascus in a week and a setback for President Ahmad al-Sharaa as he welcomed the first major Western leader to visit since the ouster of longtime dictator Bashar Assad by insurgent groups in late 2024. Syria's new rulers have wrestled with outbreaks of violence as they assert control, but the capital had been largely peaceful. French President Emmanuel Macron was in the presidential palace when the explosions happened. An official from the Elysee Palace said he was safe and the meeting with al-Sharaa continued, speaking on condition of anonymity to discuss Macron's security.

No group immediately claimed responsibility. "Nothing can smother the aspiration of Syrian women and men to live in a fully sovereign, safe, pluralistic, and united Syria," Macron said on X hours later. "This morning I met Syria in all its diversity. I saw dignity, courage and determination." Later, al-Sharaa and Macron announced they have

Highlights

It was the second attack in Damascus in a week and a setback for President Ahmad al-Sharaa

French President Emmanuel Macron was in the presidential palace when the explosions happened

Syria's new rulers have wrestled with outbreaks of violence as they assert control

agreed to reappoint ambassadors after more than a decade, marking a major restoration of diplomatic ties.

"Our meeting marks a historical milestone," al-Sharaa said. France had closed its embassy in 2012 but symbolically reopened it in early 2025. Macron, who played a major role in pushing Europe and the United States to drop most sanctions that were imposed on Syria under Assad, was in Syria before heading to Ankara, Turkey, later Tuesday for a NATO summit.

A large plume of smoke was seen at the site of the blast near the Four Seasons Hotel, where Syrian media reported Macron was staying. Footage on social media showed a van and a

motorcycle on fire and bloodstains on a busy street near the headquarters of the Tourism Ministry and the Damascus National Museum.

The Interior Ministry in a statement reported by Syrian state media said one bomb had been placed in a garbage bin and the other in a parked car. It said four of the wounded were police officers, and no deaths were immediately reported.

On Thursday, an explosive device detonated in a cafe near the Justice Palace, killing at least 10 people and wounding more than 20.

Syria's government sees Macron's visit and the signing of over a dozen agreements with Paris and large French companies as a major boost for the country's new authorities in their bid to rebuild the country battered by a 14-year uprising-turned-civil war under Assad.

One agreement was to kick off the process of returning some 51 million euros (USD 58.3 million) in illicit assets that belonged to Rifaat Assad, the late uncle of Assad. Other agreements included rebuilding the destroyed water and electricity infrastructure in the city of Homs, providing technical assistance to Syria's Central Bank as it undergoes financial reforms and bolstering cargo infrastructure at the Damascus airport.

Israeli strikes kill 7, including a child in Gaza: Medics

CAIRO: Israeli strikes and gunfire killed at least seven Palestinians, including a child, in the Gaza Strip on Tuesday, the territory's health officials said.

Medics said an Israeli airstrike killed a man and wounded two children in the Mawasi area of Khan Younis in southern Gaza. The Israeli military told Reuters they had targeted a Hamas militant.

Another Israeli airstrike hit near a tent encampment housing displaced families in western Gaza City, killing one person and wounding five others, medics said, while a third airstrike in Khan Younis killed one person and wounded three others. The Israeli military said both of those strikes had also targeted militants.

The Popular Resistance



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

“SINCE THE CEASEFIRE TOOK EFFECT EIGHT MONTHS AGO, MORE THAN 1,070 PALESTINIANS AND FOUR ISRAELI SOLDIERS HAVE BEEN KILLED”

Committees, a militant group that has long carried out armed attacks against Israel, said one of the two Israeli strikes in Khan Younis had killed a senior

leader of the group, Waheed Abu Salem.

Later on Tuesday, one Palestinian was killed and nine others were wounded by Israeli gunfire in an area of Rafah in the south of Gaza, medics and witnesses said.

Meanwhile, in Gaza City's Tel Al-Hawa neighbourhood, an Israeli airstrike hit a vehicle, killing three people, including a child, medics said, taking Tuesday's death toll across the Gaza Strip to at least seven. One of the three dead was identified as Mohammad Al-Waheidi, who worked for the Egyptian relief committee, which provides aid to Palestinians in the enclave.

The Israeli military did not immediately comment on the last two incidents. Israel has repeatedly carried out strikes in Gaza since a U.S.-mediated ceasefire with Hamas was reached last October, saying it is targeting militants who threaten its forces or who took part in the October 2023 attack on Israel. Hamas has accused Israel of violating the ceasefire. Nikolay Mladenov, U.S. President Donald Trump's appointed Board of Peace envoy to Gaza, has said both sides have violated the agreement.

Kenya, Tanzania suppress protests with heavy police deployments

NAIROBI: Heavy police deployments in the capitals of Kenya and Tanzania suppressed planned protests on Tuesday, with July 7 a significant date for the East African neighbours.

In Kenya, the day commemorates the 1990s struggle for multiparty democracy. In Tanzania, it marks the founding of what would become the ruling party 72 years ago.

Tanzania's protests were meant to call for democratic reforms following the disputed October election and to demand the release of opposition leader Tundu Lissu, who is jailed on treason charges.

In Tanzania's commercial capital, Dar es Salaam, police and military personnel were deployed and no protesters were seen. An annual trade fair continued under heavy protection.



Kenyan police officers arrest a protester, during a demonstration marking a day that is historically associated with the pro-democracy protests of the 1990s that ushered in multipartyism, in Nairobi on Tuesday

Speaking to journalists on Monday evening, Tanzania's Home Affairs Minister, Patrobas Katambi, said Tanzania was not a country where people could dictate protest dates. He added that the country was prepared to defend itself against any threat to public order.

Analysts say the government has remained on high alert since the October election and ensuing protests and crackdown that saw the deaths of hundreds of people. AGENCIES

US to lift sanctions on Turkiye, says Trump

ANKARA: US President Donald Trump said on Tuesday that the US will lift sanctions on Turkiye that were issued after Ankara purchased a Russian missile defence system that led to the country being kicked out of the F-35 fighter jet program.

There are still a number of legal hurdles before Turkiye could be fully admitted back to the US program, but the removal of the sanctions - issued under the Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act - would help ease the process for Ankara to regain access to the F-35s, a top goal of Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan and one that Trump predicted will happen eventually.

"We're going to be taking the sanctions off, OK?" Trump said in response to a question during a meeting with Erdogan at the presidential palace



US President Donald Trump

There are still a number of legal hurdles before Turkiye could be fully admitted back to the US program

in Ankara. He said Cabinet officials were working on the matter. AGENCIES

NATO unveils billions in arms deals to prove its firepower as Trump arrives in Ankara

ANKARA: US President Donald Trump arrived in Ankara Tuesday afternoon for the NATO summit, as the transatlantic military alliance was announcing billions in arms deals in an attempt to appease the mercurial US leader.

Trump was expected to head first to the presidential compound of Turkish leader Recep Tayyip Erdogan, a close ally who is hosting this year's gathering. Just before Air Force One touched down in Ankara, NATO showcased a series of military projects worth billions of dollars — an investment that the alliance's secretary-general, Mark Rutte, called "money well spent."

An energised Rutte was



US President Donald Trump arrived in Ankara

speaking to government ministers and defence industry officials at a forum billed as NATO's "big reveal," to the thrum of techno music and a

does have a fleet of 14 AWACS early warning radar surveillance planes that are about 50 years old, along with some newer surveillance drones.

A deal to replace the aging planes was announced Tuesday. Swedish manufacturer Saab will be supplying up to 10 new GlobalEye surveillance aircraft for a 10-nation consortium, Swedish Prime Minister Ulf Kristersson announced.

"It's a moment of great pride," he said, noting that the twin-engine aircraft would be "made within the alliance for all the alliance." Some of the projects will be paid for with funds from a system of cheap loans for defense purposes set up by the European Union. AGENCIES

Prince Harry loses legal battle against UK tabloid

Mail publisher was accused of violating their privacy from early 1990s to 2010s



Prince Harry

LONDON: Prince Harry's final lawsuit aimed at taming the British tabloids ended in defeat Tuesday as a judge found he failed to prove his privacy invasion claims against the publisher of the Daily Mail.

Justice Matthew Nicklin rejected the broad inferences the Duke of Sussex had relied on to try to show that Associated Newspapers Ltd. had engaged in unlawful activities. The judge said there was a realistic possibility the news came from legitimate sources.

The ruling scuttles the lawsuits filed by Harry and six others, including singer Elton John and actor-model Elizabeth Hurley, which sought substantial damages and where the legal costs for years of preparation and an 11-week trial were estimated at about 40 million pounds (USD 53.5 million).

The publisher called it an "overwhelming victory" and a "magnificent vindication" of Mail's journalism.

The case was the third and final of Harry's lawsuits accusing tabloid publishers of using unlawful tactics, such as

The publisher called it an 'overwhelming victory' and a 'magnificent vindication' of Mail's journalism

phone hacking, or hiring private detectives to dig up dirt to snoop on his life.

It was "disturbing to feel that my every move, thought or feeling was being tracked and monitored just for the Mail to make money out of it," Harry said, in legal filings.

The newspapers denied the allegations as "preposterous," insisting the roughly 50 articles at issue were based on lawful sources including friends, royal aides and publicists who offered information to reporters. The verdict, released remotely with no court hearing, coincided with Harry's visit home to the UK, which has been dominated by headlines over his latest efforts to repair a rift with his father, King Charles III. AGENCIES

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS REASI
LOOK OUT NOTICE

As requested by I/C Police Post Talwara (Reasi) vide letter No. 141/5-1/PPT dated 07.07.2026 that on 03.07.2026 information received through reliable sources at Police Post Talwara that an unidentified male dead body in decomposed condition age about 35/40 yrs, has been found floating in the reservoir of Salal Dam, Reasi. The death of the said person occurred in suspicious circumstances and the matter pertains to human being. The reason of death is not known, to ascertain the actual cause of death an Inquest Proceeding, U/S 194 BNSS was initiated at PP Talwara Reasi vide DDR No. 08 dated 03.07.2026. The description roll of un-identified male dead body is as under:-

S.No	DDR No. & dt. P/S.	Description of unidentified male dead body	Photograph of Un-identified male dead body
01.	DDR No. 08, dated 03.07.2026 of Police Post Talwara (Reasi)	Name : Un-identified male dead body S/O : Not known Age : About 35/40 Yrs Complexion : Black Body built : Normal Face : Long Type. Wearing : Naked	

It is therefore, requested that if any missing report of such person has been entered in your respective Police units/jurisdictions, resembling with above description roll of said unidentified male dead body immediate information may kindly be sent to the Web site E-mail ID sspreasi@jkpolice.gov.in, Ph. No. 01991244663, fax No. 01991245291, Ph. No. 01991244936 (PCR Reasi) or P/S Reasi No. 01991244144.

Mukund Tibrewal-IPS
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Reasi.

DIP/J-5262/26

शुद्धिपत्रक क्र. १
(ई-निविदा सूचना क्र. ०९ सन २०२६-२७)
संदर्भ :- या कार्यालयाचे पत्र जा.क्र. पवि/लेश/निविदा/२४८८, दि. २६.०६.२०२६

कायदे नंबर :- १.

Consultancy services for Feasibility Study cum DPR, Survey and Preparation of Land Plan including social, environmental and CCA mitigation study for widening to two lane with Paved Shoulders to various roads as per packages mentioned in Enclosure IV of TOR in the State of Maharashtra with financial aid of Multilateral Development Banks (Under EPC mode) Package No. 7

प्रसिद्ध झालेले	सुचारीत वाचावे	
1. Download period of online Tender	Di.02.07.2026 to 09.07.2026	Di.06.07.2026 to 13.07.2026
2. Last date and time for online raising of technical points for clarification	Online raising of technical points on or before date 06.07.2026 @ 11.00 Hrs.	Online raising of technical points on or before date 08.07.2026 @ 11.00 Hrs.
3. Last date for receiving queries for prebid/ Pre-proposal meeting (Prebid Meeting & Place)	In the Office of the Chief Engineer (Konkan) & Project Director (EAP) Konkan, Mumbai "Bandhkam Bhavan" 4 th Floor, B-Wing, 25 th Murzban Road, Fort, Mumbai-400001 on dated 06.07.2026 @ 12 Hrs.	In the Office of the Chief Engineer (Konkan) & Project Director (EAP) Konkan, Mumbai "Bandhkam Bhavan" 4 th Floor, B-Wing, 25 th Murzban Road, Fort, Mumbai-400001 on dated 08.07.2026 @ 12 Hrs.
4. E-Tender submission date and time, (Technical and Financial bid)	Di.09.07.2026 (Upto 15.00 Hrs)	Di.13.07.2026 (Upto 15.00 Hrs)
5. Last date of submission of Hard copy of Tender	Di.13.07.2026 (Upto 15.00 Hrs)	Di.15.07.2026 (Upto 15.00 Hrs)
6. E-Tender Opening Date	Di.13.07.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. (if possible) in office of the Superintending Engineer, Raigad P.W.Circle, Konkan Bhavan, Navi Mumbai.	Di.15.07.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. (if possible) in office of the Superintending Engineer, Raigad P.W.Circle, Konkan Bhavan, Navi Mumbai.

(सदर निविदेसुचनेमध्ये अथवा निविदेत कोही बदल होत असल्यास खालील सेलतकस्थळावर कळविण्यात येईल.)
१. <http://mahatenders.gov.in>

जा.क्र. साबावि/पनवेल/ई-निविदा/२०२६/
कार्यकारी अभियंता यांचे कार्यालय,
सा.बा. विभाग, पनवेल
दिनांक :-

कार्यकारी अभियंता
सार्वजनिक बांधकाम विभाग,
पनवेल
DGIPR/2026/27/1545

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
Jhajjar

Rakesh Kumar son of Satbir son of Maan Singh
Vs.
Surajbhan son of Phool Singh son of Jassu
CNR No. HRJ02-001791-2025
Next Date 01-08-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
SAHIL(MINOR) SON OF ZILE SINGH SON OF DAYANAND THROUGH ZILE SINGH :-

VILLAGE AKEHARI
MADANPUR TEHSIL
MATANHAIL AND DISTRICT
JHAJJAR
NAMAN S/O ZILE SINGH
S/O DAYANAND VILLAGE
AKEHARI MADANPUR
TEHSIL MATANHAIL AND
DISTRICT JHAJJAR

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 01-08-2026 at 10:00 a.m.
For details logon to <https://highcourthd.gov.in/?mod=districtNotice&district=Jhajjar>
Sd/-Sh. Jitesh Kumar Sharma
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
date 04-07-2026 Jhajjar

JAMSHEDPUR NOTIFIED AREA COMMITTEE
New Kalimati Road, Sakchi-831001
E- mail ID-jnacjsr@gmail.com

Short E- Procurement Notice
Tender Notice

NIT No- JNAC/30/2026-27 Date-06.07.2026

1.	Name of the work	Waste Water Management System Drains- Nimhatta, Baridih Basti and Bihari Basti Under Jamshedpur Notified Area Committee Jamshedpur. (7th Call)
2.	Estimated Cost (rs.)	Construction cost :- ₹ 6,81,74,316.00 Operation & Maintenance cost :- ₹ 50,35,648.00 Total cost :- ₹ 7,32,09,964.00
3.	Cost of Bid Document (INR)	INR 25,000/- (Twenty thousand Only) Non-Refundable.
4.	Bid Security (INR)	Bid Security: Rs 7,32,100.00
5.	Time of Completion	1 year including one month of trial run.
6.	Defect Liability Period	Defect liability period 1 years after satisfactory completion of project.
7.	O&M Period	1 year after satisfactory completion of project.
8.	Date/Time of publication of tender on website	08.07.2026 at 12:00 PM
9.	Document downloading Start date	08.07.2026 at 12:00 PM
10.	Pre bid meeting date, Time & venue	09.07.2026 at 03:00 PM, JNAC Conference Hall
11.	Bid Submission Start date	10.07.2026 at 05:00 PM
12.	Bid Submission end date	24.07.2026 at 05:00 PM
13.	Bid Opening date	25.07.2026 at 05:00PM
14.	Mode of Submission of bids	E-tendering (http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
15.	Name and address of office inviting tender	Municipal Commissioner, Jamshedpur Notified Area Committee, Jamshedpur.
16.	Email ID of E-procurement cell	jnacjsr@gmail.com

Note- 1. Only E-tender will be accepted, further details can be seen on website (<http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>)

PR 384323 Urban Development/26-27#D

Municipal Commissioner,
Jamshedpur Notified Area Committee,
Jamshedpur.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Naveen S/o Jagbir R/o** H. No. 73 B, Kunwar Singh Nagar, Nagloi, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 859/2022 U/s 356/379/411 IPC PS: Nagloi, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Naveen** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Naveen** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Naveen** accused of **FIR No. 859/2022 U/s 356/379/411 IPC PS: Nagloi, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Renu
DP/8951/OD/2026 JMFC-10, Room No. 345, First Floor
(Court Matter) Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rohit @ Babu @ Sobar Chand S/o Shepherd Chand @ Raju R/o H. No. 770, Type 1 Quarter, Gulabi Bagh, Delhi** also at H. No. 19-A, Khasra No. 33/9, Vikas Vihar, Chander Vihar, Nilothi, New Delhi-110041 has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 140/2013 U/s 392/394/323/411/34 IPC, P.S. Maurice Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rohit @ Babu @ Sobar Chand** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rohit @ Babu @ Sobar Chand** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rohit @ Babu @ Sobar Chand** of case **FIR No. 140/2013 U/s 392/394/323/411/34 IPC, P.S. Maurice Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Karanbir Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Central District, Room No. 26
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/9089/N/2026 (Court Matter)

**ICICI Bank**

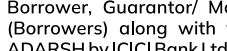
Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodara- 390007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited shal Tower Plot No. 23, New Rohtak Road Karol Bagh New Delhi- 110005

Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower
PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Home Loan LBDEL00001148606 (Credit facility) was granted to NEERU ADARSH OF BORROWER, Co-Borrower, Guarantor/ Mortgagor (excluding deceased borrower) (Borrowers) along with the deceased MR. ABHIMANYU KUMAR ADARSH by ICICI Bank Ltd, (The Bank).

We would like to inform you that the demise of MR. ABHIMANYU KUMAR ADARSH has come to our knowledge during field visits conducted by the Bank officials and by telephonic communications on the registered contact numbers. In this regard, letter dated 06 July, 2026 was previously sent to the registered addresses of the Borrowers and the deceased MR. ABHIMANYU KUMAR ADARSH, for providing information about the Legal Heirs of the deceased Borrower. Therefore, this Notice is hereby given for sharing details of the Legal Heirs of the deceased MR. ABHIMANYU KUMAR ADARSH with supporting documents for updating the Bank's records, within 15 days of publication of this Notice.

You may submit the above-mentioned details to Mr. UDAY SHANKAR by visiting Address: ICICI BANK LTD BLOCK C-1, 19TH FLOOR WORLD TRADE TOWER, SECTOR-16, UTTAR PRADESH, NOIDA - 201301.
Date: July 08, 2026
Placed: Delhi/ Ncr
Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd,

**State Urban Development Agency, Chhattisgarh**

4th Floor, D Block, Indrawati Bhawan (HOD Building), Nava Raipur Atal Nagar, Chhattisgarh, 492002
Phone 0771-2222401 Fax 0771/2222409 Email: cgd.suda@yahoo.com

RFP Notice

RFP Reference No.: PROJ-204/197/2026-SUDA (T M P F) SECTION / 403692-1

Nava Raipur Atal Nagar, Dated 03/07/2026

The State Urban Development Agency (SUDA), Chhattisgarh hereby invites proposals in conformity with the RFP document from registered and authorized agencies having experience and expertise in the similar field of work as per the criteria mentioned in the RFP document as below:

System Tender No.	Name of the Work	EMD	RFP Document Fee	Last date to download the RFP
194738	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of an Agency for the Operation and Maintenance of 47 Aspirational Toilets under SBM 2.0 in Chhattisgarh.	INR 5,00,000/-	INR 10,000/-	24.07.2026

The details regarding conditions stipulated in the RFP, EMD, Key dates for submission, detailed RFP, RFP document and all the information related to the RFP can be viewed and downloaded from e-procurement portal <https://eprc.cgstate.gov.in> or departmental website <https://suda.cg.gov.in>.

SD/-
Chief Executive Officer
State Urban Development Agency,
Nava Raipur Atal Nagar

Samvad 48366/4

**BSES**

BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE
Date: 08.07.2026

Tender under two parts (Un-priced & priced) are invited for the supply of following materials from all bidders:-

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Estimated Cost (₹)	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/ FK/PR/RJ/1370	SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING & COMMISSIONING OF 1600 KVA PAD MOUNTED PSS IN BRPL, NEW DELHI	4.10 Crores	8,20,000	29.07.2026 15:00 HRS	29.07.2026 15:30 HRS

Cost of each Tender Document: ₹ 180/-
For any query call on 011-49107235 or e-mail on Brpl.Eauction@reliancegroupindia.com
For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submission of tender documents etc. please visit our website www.bsedelhi.com Head (Contracts & Materials)
Regd. Off. : BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PLC111527
Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235 | Website : www.bsedelhi.com

**GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA**

Public Works Division, Dharashiv

E-Tender Notice No. :- 04/2026-27

Online Tenders Works are invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division, Dharashiv (Phone No. 02472-222882/83) in B-1 / B-2 from eligible contractors.
Website :- <http://mahatenders.gov.in> & <https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in>

(S. J. Ket)
Executive Engineer
Public Works Division, Dharashiv
Dgipr/2026-27/1539

**BSES**

BSES Yamuna Power Limited, Delhi

NOTICE INVITING TENDER
Date: 08.07.2026

E-tenders are invited under the Two-Bid System (Un-priced & Priced Bid) for the following materials/works:-

NIT & SRM RFx No.	Tender Description	Estimated Cost (₹)	Cost of EMD (₹)	Due Date / Time (Submission/Opening)
CMC/BY/26-27/RB/ PM/VK/17 [RFx No: 2200000224]	Civil work for proposed new extension of SGR & construction of toilet block & other foundations at 66 KV grid substation Khichpur in division Mayur Vihar Phase-I/II	1.70 Crore	3.40 Lakh	29.07.2026 / 15:00 Hrs (Submission) 29.07.2026 / 15:30 Hrs (Opening)
CMC/BY/26-27/RB/ PM/VK/18 [RFx No: 2200000225]	Civil work required for construction of PTR Plinth, RCC Fire wall & RCC NIFS Soak Pit, APFC capacitor bank foundations, partition wall with doors & CC road at 33KV Shakarpur Grid (D) Laxmi Nagar	1.13 Crore	2.26 Lakh	29.07.2026 / 15:00 Hrs (Submission) 29.07.2026 / 15:30 Hrs (Opening)

Cost of each Tender Document: ₹1,180/- (Non-refundable)
For detailed information on the Equipment, Bill of Materials (BOM), Services, Qualifying Requirements, Terms and Conditions, Technical Specifications, and submission of Tender Documents - including any corrigendum - please visit our website at www.bsedelhi.com → BSES Yamuna Power Ltd → Tenders → Open Tenders, or access our e-tendering portal at <https://srmprportal.bsedelhi.com/nrjportal>.
Head (Contracts & Materials)
Regd.Off: BSES Yamuna Power Ltd, Shakti Kiran Building, Karkardooma, Delhi-110032 | CIN: U40109DL2001PLC111525
Website: www.bsedelhi.com TEL: 011-41247111

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No. 5120262027
E-Tender Notice
Dated: 06.07.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works up to 13:30 hrs. on **29.07.2026**. The details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: 116 **Approx Cost of Work (Rs.):** Rs. 56,79,517.60

Name of work: Carrying out photogrammetry topographical survey and preparation of Yard ESP of various stations under DEN/V/PRYU.

Earnest Money (Rs.): Rs. 1,13,600.00 **Completion Period:** 02 Months

Date of Opening of tender: 29.07.2026

Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Engineering survey of Railway line/Roadway

Note:- 1. Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on **29.07.2026**. 2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. **29.07.2026** 1543/26(K)

  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**SURYODAY**

Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited
Regd. & Corp. office: 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector - 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai - 400614. CIN: L65923MH2008PLC281472.

POSSESSION NOTICE

Whereas The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd., under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (ACT NO.54 OF 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a demand notice to below mentioned Borrower/s / Guarantor/s. After completion of 60 days from date of receipt of the said notice, The Borrower/s / Guarantor/s having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower/s / Guarantor/s and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on them under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 6 & 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on the date mentioned herewith:-

Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice
257000011448, 1) MR. YED PRAKASH S/O MAYANK CHAND, 2) MRS. SAROJ DEVI W/O YED PRAKASH	08.01.2026

Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.	Date of Possession
Rs. 16,62,935.67/- as on 06.01.2026	06.07.2026 (Physical)

Description of Secured Asset(S) /Immovable Property (ies) : ALL THE PIECE AND PARCEL OF PORTION BEARING PVT. NO. S-203, ON FIRST FLOOR (BACK SIDE), WITHOUT ROOF RIGHT, HAVING AN AREA MEASURING 57 SQ. YARDS, CONSISTING OF TWO BEDROOMS, ONE DRAWING-CUM-DINING ROOM, ONE KITCHEN, ONE TOILETS-CUM-BATHROOMS, OF PROPERTY BEARING NO. 24, BUILT ON A PLOT OF LAND MEASURING 200 SQ. YDS. PART OF KHASRA NO. 154/1 AND 155, SITUATED IN THE REVENUE ESTATE OF VILLAGE TAJPUR, P.O. BADARPUR, NEW DELHI-110044. BOUNDARIES: EAST: OTHER PROPERTY, WEST: FRONT UNIT ROAD 20 FT, NORTH: PROPERTY OF JILE SINGH, SOUTH: PROPERTY OF SHRI RAJIVER

The Borrower/s / Guarantor/s in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the M/s Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd, for an above mentioned demanded amount and further interest thereon.
Date : 08.07.2026, Place : Delhi Authorised Officer, Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system.

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
1	77269051 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS FOR 1 IN 12, 60KG TURNOUT (SLEEPER NO.65 TO 83) DRG. NO: T-4218	200 SET	27.07.26
2	77269052 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT OF PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS FOR 1 IN 12, 60 KG TURNOUT (SLEEPER NO.66 TO 69) DRG. NO: T-4218	500 SET	31.07.26
3	19262711	ROLLER BEARING RB 5020	519 NOS	31.07.26
4	19260703	SET OF LOCK NUT F.S. ALL STEEL	200 SET	03.08.26
5	19260602	AXLE BOX BEARING	339 SET	03.08.26
6	77269053 RGC	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR PROCUREMENT OF PRESTRESSED CONCRETE SLEEPERS FOR 1 & 5, 60KG TURNOUT (SLEEPER NO.41 TO 54) TO RDSO DRG. T-4665	100 SET	03.08.26
7	08265165	6 QUAD CABLE 1.4MM	47 KM	04.08.26
8	16264269	SPIN-ON FUEL FILTER,	2007 NOS	06.08.26
9	04250057B	TRANSFORMER OIL FOR THREE PHASE	32813 LTR	10.08.26

Note:-1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. **2. No Manual offer will be entertained.**

Tender Notice No. 24/2026-2027 Dated: 06/07/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2311/26

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender No.: CNB2026202701
Dated: 03.07.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer/Construction, North Central Railway, Opposite Jhakarkati Bus Stand, G.T. Road, Kanpur-208001, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders for the following works with closing date/time as mentioned below. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

Brief Description of Work: Provision of FOB 3m wide with ramps & other allied works at Sirhi Itara, Kathara, Patara, Dohru and Dapsaura stations on Bhimsen - Yamuna South Bank Section in C/with Doubling work between Khairar- Bhimsen station of North Central Railway.

Approximate Cost:-	Amount of EMD:-
₹ 25.29 Crore	₹ 50,57,200/-

Cost of Tender Document: ₹ 0.00 Completion Period : 06 Months

Tender Closing Date : 05.08.2026 at 15:00 Hours

Note:- (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-works tender will be available on website on <https://ireps.gov.in> up to 15:00 hrs on the due date of tender opening. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rate entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by tenderer shall be straight way ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. (5) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1533/26(A)

  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No. DY. CEE-PRYJPU2627T01
E-Tender Notice
Date : 04.07.2026

PCEE/Construction for Electrical Project Unit acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites following E-Tender, the detail of the tender is as under:-

T.No. : PRYJPU2627T01 Advertised value : Rs. 451369360.23

Description of work : Design, Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning for upgradation of existing 1x25kV Electric Traction System into 2x25kV Electric Traction System Chunar-Chopra Section of Prayagraj Division of North Central Railway.

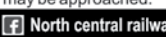
Bid Security : Rs. 9027400.00 Period of Completion : 24 Months

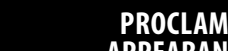
Bidding system : Two Packet System

Tender Closing date & Time : 27.07.2026 & 15:00 Hrs

Tender opening date & Time : 27.07.2026 & 15:30 Hrs

Note : 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1541/26 (C)

  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Mike S/o Obinnjekwe @Oluchukwu R/o C-85/2, Gali No.8, near Mohanpuri School, Moujpur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 31/2015 U/s 21 NDPS & 14 Foreigners ACT, PS Crime Branch, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Mike** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mike** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Mike** in **FIR No. 31/2015 U/s 21 NDPS & 14 Foreigners ACT, PS Crime Branch, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.08.2026**.

By order
Sh. Virender Singh
Special Judge (NDPS)
Central District, Room No. 222
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/9277/Crime/2026

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Gyandev S/o Late Pritam Nath Dev, R/o 07, South Ganesh Nagar, Shakarpur, Delhi, Also at:** Chanwila, Munger, Bihar-813212, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 92/2021, U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Patparganj Industrial Area, East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gyandev** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gyandev** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Gyandev** the said accused of **FIR No. 92/2021, U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Patparganj Industrial Area, East Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. P. Bhargav Rao
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (East), Room No. 03, 2nd Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi-32
DP/9208/ED/2026 (Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Akmal Zaidi, S/o: Late Aslam Zaidi, R/o: H.No. G-83, Thokar No. 4, Okhla, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 93/2023, U/s: 279/338 IPC, Police Station Darya Ganj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Akmal Zaidi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Akmal Zaidi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Akmal Zaidi of Police Station Darya Ganj, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.08.2026**.

By Order
Dr. Raj Kumar Singh
JMFC (NI Act) 05, Central, Room No. 241
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/9084/CD/2026

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

e-OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

Name of work with location, cost of work and Earnest money	Augmentation of PNP Running Room by constructing an additional Building Comprising of 12 New Rooms in the Existing Running room in the section of SSE/W/PNP under ADEN/PNP. Approx. Cost : Rs. 14150403.02/-
Earnest Money	Rs. 283000/-
Completion Period	12 Months
Date and time of submission of tender and opening of tender.	Upto 15.00 hrs on 28.07.2026, opening of e-tender after 15.00 hrs on 28.07.2026.
Website particulars, published-tender, notice location etc complete details of tender can be seen and web site where the tender form can be downloaded	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
Similar nature of work	Construction of any building/Quater.
No: 128/W/280/Tender Notice/26-27/W-I (NIT-18) Dated: 06.07.2026	2308/2026

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**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Arti, W/o: Deepak, R/o: Premises Opp Plot No-7, Ground Floor, Khasra No-53/14/1, Gali No-3, Sainik Enclave-II, Jharoda Kalan, New Delhi-110072** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT Case No.: 86/2025, U/s: 135 Electricity ACT, P.S. Baba Haridas Nagar, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Arti** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Arti** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Arti of P.S. Baba Haridas Nagar, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Harleen Singh
ASJ (South West Distt.),
Special Court Electricity, Room No. 609, Dwarka Courts, New Delhi
DP/9129/DW/2026

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nikhil, S/o: Ajay, R/o: H.No. F7/64, W-49, T-Huts, Sultanpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 80064886/2024, U/s: 380/456/411/34 IPC, Police Station Raj Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nikhil** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nikhil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nikhil of Police Station Raj Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha
JMFC-3, 1st Floor, Room No. 107, Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/9009/OD/2026

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**

TENDER NOTICE

The Chief Engineer/Const./HQ, Northern Railway, Kashmir Gate, Delhi, for and on behalf of the President of India invites **Open e-tender** under **Two Packet System** of the under noted work:-

1. Full Name of work	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Agency for Development and Implementation of digital tools for Document Management for Indian Railways, (DMS).
2. Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 4.03,92,530/-
3. Completion period of the work	12 months with AMC of 2 years.
4. Bid security (Cash/BG) to be deposited	Rs. 8,07,900/-
5. Sale/availability of tender document on Rly. Website	Tender documents will be available on IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in from 06.07.2026 to 31.07.2026 upto 12:30 hrs.
6. Pre-Bid Conference	13-07-2026 at 15:30 hours at CAO/C Office, N. Rly., Kashmir Gate, Delhi and through online V/Link.
7. Last date of receipt of pre-bid queries	14-07-2026 upto 18:00 hrs
8. Authority response to queries	17-07-2026 upto 18:00 hrs
9. Last date/Time of upload of tenders	31.07.2026 upto 12:30 hours. Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS website w.e.f. 17.07.2026 to 31.07.2026
10. Date and time of opening of tender	31.07.2026 upto 12:30 hours. The detailed tender notice also can be seen on the Notice Board of the above office.

Tender Notice No. 74-W-4-1-487-WA-HQ Dated :- 06.07.2026 2318/2026

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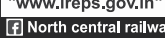
**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-July-01 dated 03.07.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under :-

SN: 1.	Tender No.: 2026-July-01-01	Approx Cost Rs.: 5499479.53
Description of work :	Replacement of Stone Slab Bridge by RCC Box culvert at Bridge No. 147 at Km 80/12-13 in IDH-BKI Section.	
SN: 2.	Tender No.: 2026-July-01-02	Approx Cost Rs.: 52108000.00
Description of work :	Supply, stacking and mechanized loading into hoppers/box of 50000 cum machine crushed stone ballast as per Railway specification/IS/RDSO GE/0001:Feb-2023 or latest at Achnera (AH) Depot.	
SN: 3.	Tender No.: 2026-July-01-03	Approx Cost Rs.: 31566254.25
Description of work :	Re-development of office cum rest room complex at Shivaji Bridge, New Delhi.	

* For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in" * Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 hrs on 24.07.2026. 1531/26(A)

  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in 

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Okpala James, S/o: Okpala Benignus, R/o: 132, Top Floor, Arjun Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 118/2016, Dated 10/07/2016 & U/s: 21 NDPC ACT & 14 Foreigners ACT, P.S. Crime Branch, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Okpala James** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Okpala James** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Okpala James of P.S. Crime Branch, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Virender Singh
Special Judge NDPS, Central Distt., Room No. 222, DP/8934/

EV sales rise 63% to all-time high of 3,06,220 units in June

Electric PV retail sales jumped over two-fold at 31,823 units in June against 15,318 units in June 2025, FADA said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Electric vehicle retail sales in India reached an all-time high of 3,06,220 units in June, growing at 63 per cent over the same month last year, taking overall EV penetration to over 12 per cent for the first time, the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations said on Tuesday.

The growth in EV sales was led by the two-wheeler segment at 1,93,735 units in June as against 1,10,719 units in the same month last year, up 74.98 per cent, Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) said in a statement.

Electric passenger vehicle (PV) retail sales jumped over two-fold at 31,823 units last month as against 15,318 units in June 2025, it added.

The three-wheeler electric segment saw total retail of 77,448 units as against 60,802 units in the same month last year, up 27.38 per cent, it added.

Electric commercial vehicle (CV) retail stood at 3,214 units last month as compared to 1,219 units in June last year, up 163.7 per cent, FADA said.

Commenting on the EV retail sales, FADA President C S Vigneshwar said, "June 2026



The growth in EV sales was led by the two-wheeler segment at 1,93,735 units in June as against 1,10,719 units in the same month last year, up 74.98%, FADA said

was a defining month in India's mobility transition. The industry retailed 3,06,220 electric vehicles - an all-time high in FADA's records and nearly 63 per cent higher than a year ago."

The growth happened despite the broader market navigating a delayed monsoon and a seasonally lean patch, he said, adding, "encouragingly, this was not a single-category story."

Electric PVs and electric CVs both delivered their best-ever month, Vigneshwar noted.

"With overall EV penetration crossing 12 per cent for the first time -- led by three-wheelers, where over 64 per cent of retail is now electric, and two-wheelers, now in double digits at 10.6 per cent -- electrification has moved decisively from the margins to the mainstream of Indian auto retail," Vigneshwar said.

What makes this transition durable is its breadth and its ownership, he added. "Legacy manufacturers now lead the electric two-wheeler

KEY POINTS

» 'The growth happened despite the broader market navigating a delayed monsoon and a seasonally lean patch'

» Retail sales of electric three-wheelers also rose 27.38% year-on-year to 77,448 units in June 2026 from 60,802 units in June last year

» Commercial EV retail sales rose 163.7% year-on-year to 3,214 units in June 2026 from 1,219 units in June 2025

space, established players are scaling electric cars and commercial vehicles, and new entrants - both Indian and global - are choosing India as a priority market," Vigneshwar said.

He termed it as "the India growth story expressing itself in clean, self-reliant mobility -- rising aspiration, widening affordability, and a customer increasingly ready to go electric wherever the product, the charging ecosystem and the economics come together".

GAINS IN IT STOCKS CAPPED LOSSES IN KEY INDICES

Sensex, Nifty end lower after 4-day rally on last minute profit-taking

OUR CORRESPONDENT

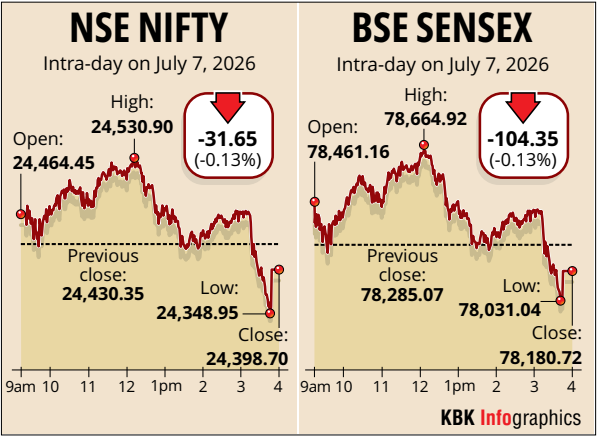
MUMBAI: Benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty closed lower on Tuesday due to last-minute profit-taking after a four-day rally and weak Asian trends.

Paring its early gains, the 30-share BSE Sensex declined by 104.35 points, or 0.13 per cent, to close at 78,180.72. During the day, it climbed 379.85 points, or 0.48 per cent, to 78,664.92.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dipped 31.65 points, or 0.13 per cent, to end at 24,398.70. Sensex and Nifty had rallied more than 2 per cent in the last four sessions to hit more than two-month high levels on Monday.

Among Sensex shares, Trent emerged as the top loser, tumbling 12.42 per cent after its June quarter revenue growth missed market expectations. Adani Ports, Bharat Electronics, Larsen & Toubro, Reliance Industries and ICICI Bank were also among the laggards.

Gains in IT shares, however, capped losses in key indices. HCL Tech led the gains, rising by 3.08 per cent ahead of the announcement of financial results. Tech Mahindra, Infosys, and Tata Consultancy Services also advanced. TCS will announce the quarterly results on Thursday, marking the start of earnings season for Indian IT players.



Among IT stocks, HCL Tech led the gains, rising by 3.08 per cent ahead of the announcement of financial results, followed by Tech Mahindra, Infosys, and Tata Consultancy Services

Among others Titan jumped 2.62 per cent after the company reported a 41 per cent growth in its revenue for the June quarter of FY27, driven by strong performances across its jewellery, watches and eyewear segments.

Eternal rose by 2.12 per cent. The BSE SmallCap Select index declined 1.08 per cent and MidCap Select index dipped 0.15 per cent.

Sectorally, Capital Goods dropped 1.73 per cent, followed by Realty lost 1.61 per cent, Industrials (1.49 per cent), Power (1.12 per cent), Metal

(1.04 per cent), Commodities (0.90 per cent) and Hospitals (0.90 per cent).

Focused IT surged 2.25 per cent, IT jumped 2.12 per cent, Consumer Durables (0.65 per cent), MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (0.55 per cent) and Oil & Gas (0.09 per cent). A total of 2,633 stocks declined, while 1,599 advanced and 165 remained unchanged on the BSE.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 1.22 per cent to \$72.87 per barrel. In Asian markets, South

HIGHLIGHTS

» Among others Titan jumped 2.62 per cent after the company reported a 41 per cent growth in its revenue for the June quarter of FY27 & Eternal rose by 2.12 per cent

» From Sensex pack, Trent emerged as top loser, tumbling 12.42%. Adani Ports, Bharat Electronics, L&T, Reliance Industries & ICICI Bank were also among the laggards

» The BSE SmallCap Select index declined 1.08 per cent and MidCap Select index dipped 0.15 per cent

Korea's Kospi tanked 4.91 per cent. Japan's Nikkei 225, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng also ended lower. Markets in Europe were trading on a mixed note. US markets ended higher on Monday.

FIIs bought equities worth Rs 243.03 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

On Monday, the Sensex jumped 521.16 points, or 0.67 per cent, to settle at 78,285.07. The Nifty climbed 159.50 points, or 0.66 per cent, to end at 24,430.35.

Rupee rises 47 paise to 94.96 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated 47 paise to close at 94.96 against the US dollar on Tuesday, on improved global risk sentiments as higher traffic flows through the Strait of Hormuz reduced supply uncertainties.

Forex traders said market sentiment was also buoyed after Saudi Arabia slashed August crude oil prices for Asia by \$11 per barrel.

Moreover, softness in Brent oil prices will ease inflationary pressures for India, the world's third-largest oil importer, market analysts said.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.33 and traded in the range of 94.93-95.37 in intraday trade. At the end of Tuesday's trading session, the rupee was quoted at 94.96, higher by 47 paise over its previous close.

On Monday, the rupee depreciated 25 paise to close at 95.43 against the US dollar.

"The Indian rupee gained sharply today on improved global risk sentiments and a weak dollar. Softness in crude oil prices too supported the rupee as it is likely to ease inflationary pressure. Disappointing ISM services PMI too supported the rupee," said Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 100.96, up 0.11 per cent. PFI

Sitharaman asks Indian toy manufacturers to target one-fourth of \$179 bn global market

NEW DELHI: Citing the toy industry's vast growth potential, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday said Indian manufacturers should aspire to capture at least a one-fourth of the global toy market share, which is estimated to reach \$179 billion by 2032.

India exports toys to 153 countries and their value reached \$186 million in 2025-26, while imports have come down drastically by 71 per cent during 2019-26, she said in her address at the International toy exhibition here.

India's toy market is projected to reach \$56 billion by 2034, while the global toy market is projected to reach \$179 billion by 2032, she said.

"We are still aiming at only (USD) five billion by 2034. I think we are capable of doing



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

a lot better. We have immense potential to capture; at least aim for one quarter of it (\$179 billion). That's a big number, no doubt. But we should aim at higher. Our aspiration must be far greater to capture a significantly larger share of the expanding global market," the minister said.

Sitharaman said toy imports were earlier concentrated from

one country, which was dumping a lot of their cheap goods that had safety issues and were not healthy for children.

She also asked the industry to focus on scale and branding. "Manufacturing is important, but branding creates value. Enduring value is only when your brand can be identified. Aankh band karke kharid lo (Buy it without a second thought), that kind of a branding confidence should come," she said.

Citing the example of French sports retailer Decathlon, she said: "I was impressed to see how they spend time for quality, and also for branding".

Sporting goods market has been seeing a lot of innovation, and they bring it into their stalls, she said.

"That's the kind of thing

I'm asking."

The government has taken a series of measures to boost manufacturing of toys and reduce import dependence from countries like China.

The government has rolled out mandatory quality control norms and increased import duties from 20 per cent to 60 per cent.

It developed a comprehensive National Action Plan for Toys in 2020 to boost local manufacturing and incentivise toy and handicraft manufacturers to make India the next global hub of toys.

The plan is implemented in collaboration with 14 central ministries/departments, including education, textiles, railways, science and technology, and information and broadcasting. PFI

Over ₹1.55 lakh crore guarantee cover issued under ECLGS 5.0: FinMin

NEW DELHI: The Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) 5.0 has crossed 4.11 lakh guarantees to businesses affected by the West Asia geopolitical situation, with the guaranteed amount reaching over Rs 1.55 lakh crore, the Finance Ministry said on Tuesday.

The scheme has benefited India's small businesses with 98 per cent of the total number of guarantees and 82 per cent of the total guaranteed amount going to MSMEs.

"Since launch, 4,11,497 guarantees have been issued under ECLGS 5.0, with the guaranteed amount reaching Rs 1,55,229 crore — a sign of the scheme's rapid absorp-

tion across the lending ecosystem," the ministry said in a statement.

The ECLGS 5.0 was approved by the Union Cabinet on May 5, 2026. The scheme aims to infuse additional credit of Rs 2.55 lakh crore to existing borrowers to tide over the liquidity challenges arising due to the West Asia crisis.

As the scheme evolves and outreach expands, it is expected to further strengthen liquidity support for businesses, including MSMEs and enable entrepreneurs to meet their liquidity needs in times of external challenges, the ministry added. PFI

Gold tumbles ₹1,400 to ₹1.49 lakh per 10 grams

NEW DELHI: Gold prices fell sharply by Rs 1,400 to Rs 1.49 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday, and silver slipped Rs 200, as a stronger rupee and weak global trends weighed on the precious metals.

The yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity depreciated by Rs 1,400 to Rs 1,49,250 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes) from Monday's closing level of Rs 1,50,650 per 10 grams.

Silver prices also eased by Rs 200 to Rs 2,39,800 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes), after settling at Rs 2,40,000 per kg in the previous session.

Analysts said domestic bullion prices also came under pressure as the rupee appreciated sharply against the US dollar.

"Gold prices extended their weakness after the rupee appreciated by 48 paise against the US dollar, which weighed on domestic bullion," said Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst - Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities.

In the international market, spot gold fell \$24.54, or 0.59 per cent, to \$4,140.59 per ounce, and silver declined nearly 2 per cent to \$60.89 per ounce.

"Spot gold is trading lower in the overseas trade as crude oil prices have staged a minor rebound following attacks on shipping in and around the Strait of Hormuz," Praveen Singh, Head of Commodities at Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said. PFI

PM Modi launches NHPC's Karnisar Solar Power Plant in Rajasthan

Project marks a significant addition to India's renewable energy capacity & nation's commitment to clean energy

NEW DELHI: NHPC's 300 MW Karnisar Solar Power Plant at Bikaner, Rajasthan, was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, through virtual mode on 04 July 2026.

The project marks a significant addition to India's renewable energy capacity and underscores the nation's commitment to clean energy and sustainable development.

The inauguration was held in the august presence of Governor of Rajasthan Haribhav Kisanrao Bagde, Chief Minister of Rajasthan Bhajan Lal Sharma, Union Petroleum & Natural Gas Minister Hardeep



Singh Puri and Deputy CMs of Rajasthan Diya Kumari and Dr. Prem Chand Bairwa.

Speaking on the occasion, the Prime Minister emphasized that renewable energy is the cornerstone of India's energy security and sustainable future. He further highlighted

CLOSER LOOK

» Prime Minister emphasized that renewable energy is cornerstone of India's energy security, sustainable future

» Rajasthan is witnessing development of world-class solar power infra, reinforcing its position as a key contributor to the nation's clean energy ambitions, Modi said

that Rajasthan is witnessing the development of world-class solar power infrastructure, reinforcing its position as a key contributor to the nation's clean energy ambitions.

Bhupender Gupta, CMD, NHPC, expressed his sincere gratitude to Prime Minis-

ter Narendra Modi, the Government of India, the Govt of Rajasthan, the Ministry of Power, the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy and all other stakeholders for their continued guidance and support in the successful execution of the project. He reaffirmed

NHPC's commitment to contributing towards India's clean energy and renewable energy goals.

The 300 MW Karnisar Solar Power Plant represents NHPC's continued commitment towards strengthening India's renewable energy capacity and supporting the GoI's vision of Aatma Nirbhar Bharat, with the project being developed using approximately 7.75 lakh domestically manufactured Solar PV Cells and Modules.

The solar power plant is expected to generate around 75 crore units of clean electricity

annually, significantly contributing to the nation's renewable energy basket while helping offset nearly 6.4 lakh tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions every year, thereby promoting environmental sustainability and supporting India's climate commitments.

Besides producing clean energy, the project has also contributed to the socio-economic development of the region by creating direct and indirect employment opportunities for over 40 local persons, thereby generating sustainable livelihoods in the remote areas of Rajasthan. MPOST

Reserve Bank to conduct ₹25K cr VRR auction today

MUMBAI: The RBI on Tuesday said it will conduct an overnight variable rate repo (VRR) auction for a notified amount of Rs 25,000 crore on July 8.

The auction will take place between 9:30 am and 10:00 am on Wednesday, and the funds will be reversed on July 9, according to the RBI's notification.

"On a review of current and evolving liquidity conditions, it has been decided to conduct a VRR auction on Wednesday, July 8," the RBI said in a release.

Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around Rs 1.19 lakh crore as of July 6, accord-

ing to the RBI's data.

On July 7, the central bank received a muted response on the overnight VRR auction, with just Rs 1,135 crore worth of bids for a notified amount of Rs 50,000 crore. Experts attributed this to the comfortable surplus liquidity in the banking system. The RBI accepted the entire amount at a cut-off and weighted average rate of 5.26 per cent, according to the release.

The RBI had infused more than Rs 6 lakh crore of transient liquidity to the banking system through various VRR auctions ranging between overnight and seven days since June. PFI



'MOST HEROES DON'T LISTEN TO FEMALE DIRECTORS'

Huma Qureshi opened up about Toxic's acclaimed director Geetu Mohandas

The teaser for Yash's highly awaited film 'Toxic: A Fairytale for Grown-Ups' was released recently. Fans are excited to watch the upcoming gangster-action, especially because of its stellar ensemble cast. In a recent interview, Huma Qureshi, who plays the character Elizabeth in the film, opened up about the film's acclaimed director Geetu Mohandas. The actress also shared that the movie will leave everyone 'shaken'.

During a podcast with 'The Lallantop', she was asked about her upcoming film 'Toxic' during an audience interaction session. "I feel like people have seen nothing like 'Toxic' here ever before. So, just wait. All the lead actresses who are in the film have performed really well. I am not just talking about myself; I am talking about everyone," she replied.

Qureshi went on to reveal that while it's difficult to make a film as a female filmmaker, Mohandas has done exceptionally well. "If you are aware of Geetu Mohandas' work, she is actually an art-house Malayali filmmaker. If you have seen her films before, they are all just amazing. She has also received international acclaim for her movies. So, when she offered this film to me, I was excited about the possibility of a female filmmaker," she said.



Huma continued, "It is very difficult to work in this industry, especially in the commercial world, because a lot of actors mostly don't like taking orders from a female director. The fact that Geetu Mohandas is directing such a big film, casting a superstar like Yash, they have a very healthy collaboration."

She concluded by stating that 'Toxic' will surely exceed everyone's expectations. "This film that they have made will leave everyone shaken. And if such big actresses are working in it, then there must be something huge happening, right? Just keep some patience and you'll see," she expressed.

AGENCIES

Anshula and Rohan get married

She shared a series of pictures from the celebrations on her 'Instagram'



Anshula Kapoor tied the knot with screenwriter and director Rohan Thakkar.

Anshula, daughter of producer Boney Kapoor and the late Mona Shourie Kapoor and sister of the Bollywood actor Arjun Kapoor, shared a series of pictures from the celebrations on her 'Instagram' on Monday. It featured the couple holding hands, along with other pictures from the celebrations.

Anshula wore a peach-coloured lehenga, which she complemented with a golden scarf and statement jewellery. Rohan wore an ivory-gold sherwani. "06.07.2026. Of all the people. Of all the places. Of all the timing. It was you. And somehow, through every twist, detour and surprise, it is still you. My favourite conversation. My safest place. My easiest choice. Always you @rohanthakkar1511," she wrote in the caption.

Anshula wore a peach-coloured lehenga, which she complemented with a golden scarf and statement jewellery

The couple dated for years and got engaged in October 2025. They announced the engagement with a social media post. "Somehow, even back then, it felt like the start of something that mattered. 3 years later, in my favourite city, in front of the castle in Central Park, he proposed! At exactly 1.15 AM India time! And somehow the world paused just long enough. Just the quiet kind of love that feels like home... What @rohanthakkar1511 gave me that day was better. Because it was intentional. Thoughtful. Real. Us. I said yes," it read.

PTI

The actress also shared that the movie will leave everyone 'shaken'

The Greatest: The life & legacy of Muhammad Ali

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The highly anticipated Muhammad Ali series, 'The Greatest', is set to premiere on 'Prime Video' on November 4, 2026. The announcement was made during a special first-look presentation on the main stage at 'Essence Festival of Culture', moderated by ESPN and ABC News' journalist Kelley Carter.

Joining the conversation were creator, showrunner and executive producer Ben Watkins; star Jaalen Best, who portrays Cassius Clay/Muhammad Ali and cast members Dana Gourrier, Amin Joseph, Kai Parham and Michael Ealy. Attendees were treated to an exclusive preview of the series via a first-look teaser and a conversation about bringing the life and legacy of Muhammad Ali to the screen.

'The Greatest' is an intimate exploration of the incomparable life of the boxing



The highly anticipated web series stars Jaalen Best, who will portray the boxing champion, humanitarian and global icon

champion, humanitarian and global icon. Executive produced by Lonnie Ali, the widow of the late luminary, 'The Greatest' is the first authorised scripted series about the life of Muhammad Ali, offering unprecedented access and going beyond the amazing victories and defeats that made Ali a legend, both in and out of the ring.

SHERATON NEW DELHI HOTEL

Sufi Nights: A celebration of soulful music & fine dining

Sheraton New Delhi Hotel is delighted to present 'Sufi Nights', a captivating musical experience that brings together the timeless charm of live Sufi performances, exceptional dining and warm hospitality. The event takes place every Friday and Saturday from 7:30 pm onwards, offering guests an evening of soulful melodies and memorable moments.

The event takes place every Friday and Saturday from 7:30 pm onwards

Set against the elegant backdrop of Sheraton New Delhi Hotel, 'Sufi Nights' creates the perfect setting for families, friends, couples and music enthusiasts to unwind and immerse themselves in the rich cultural heritage of Sufi music. Guests can enjoy an enchanting live singing performance while indulging in a thoughtfully curated dining experience featuring authentic 'Dehlnavi' cuisine.

Blending culture, flavour and hospitality,



Event Details

What: Sufi Nights

When: Every Friday & Saturday, 7:30 pm onwards

Where: Sheraton New Delhi Hotel

For reservations and more information, guests may contact Sheraton New Delhi Hotel at +919205909854

'Sufi Nights' is designed to offer a unique and immersive evening for those seeking meaningful celebrations, leisurely gatherings or simply an escape into the world of soulful music.

MPOST

'It's not every day you have Octavia's face on a 'Zoom' call'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video's 'Ride or Die' pairs Academy Award winner Octavia Spencer and Emmy winner Hannah Waddingham for the first time in an action-comedy that revolves around two lifelong best friends whose unbreakable bond is put to the ultimate test. While their on-screen chemistry drives the series, bringing Waddingham on board as Judith turned out to be one of the easiest decisions the team had to make.

For Spencer, Waddingham felt like the only choice for Judith from the very beginning. Talking about how quickly she knew Waddingham was the right person for the role, Spencer shared, "It's funny because she was the person on all of our minds, you know, I did what I wasn't supposed to do. They pitched me the show and it was like someone

asking you to marry them on the first date. And I said, 'Absolutely. I will.' Then they literally asked, 'Well, who do you think should be Judith?' And I said, 'Hannah Waddingham.' And they were like, 'Thank God, because that's what we think as well!'

For Waddingham, the offer came as a complete surprise during a 'Zoom'

Hannah Waddingham recalled the moment when Spencer offered her 'Ride or Die'

call with Spencer and writer Tessa Coates. "We were on a 'Zoom' call and it's not every day you have Octavia Spencer's face on a 'Zoom' call and Tessa Coates, our writer. I hadn't really concentrated on what the week

was about. I was just so overwhelmed to be at this meeting. I said, 'Oh, you know, what do you want to do?' Like, you know, say something about the script. Her whole face fills the screen and she goes, 'We want you to play Judith, ya dummy!' and I just thought I had to do this."



'I've been at home for a year with no work'

Kunal Kemmu made a successful directorial debut with 'Madgaon Express'

Kunal Kemmu, who made a successful directorial debut with 'Madgaon Express', recently opened up about the uncertainty that comes with a career in Bollywood. Kunal, who was also recently seen hosting Prime Video's reality show 'The Alliance', spoke about the fear of staying relevant, the creative compromises actors often make and the periods of inactivity that are an inevitable part of the profession.

Speaking to 'News18', he admitted that actors often find themselves torn between creative satisfaction and the need to keep working. "Sometimes you're faced with the challenge of thinking, 'I don't really feel creatively fulfilled or satisfied doing this part.' But at the end of the day, I'm not working for a long time, so I just do it because, ultimately, I'm trying to do what I need to. I think that's something that most actors struggle with, especially when you're not doing enough work or there isn't enough work around. There's often a battle between what you really want to do and the opportunities that are in front of you."

He further explained the dilemma actors

face while deciding whether to wait for the right opportunity or make the best of what's available. "Do you just not do anything and wait until you land what you want? Or do you say, 'Okay, let me make the best of what I have, even though this isn't creatively 100 per cent there for me?'

For me, I've always been somebody who really needs to connect with the work and enjoy it, because the only reason I became an actor - now I do other things as well - is that acting brought me joy and made me happy. That's why I chose not to do anything else and to pursue this and I knew what came with it. So yeah, that's the only bit, I think, which is challenging for me and I know for a fact it's the same for many other actors."

When asked whether he had personally experienced a lull in his career, Kemmu said such phases are a recurring reality for actors. "No, it happens all the time. I mean, now I'm busier. But there were times in my life when I went for almost two years where I was just working. Then one film doesn't work and sometimes I've been at home for six months."



He opened up about the uncertainty that comes with a career in Bollywood